

Choice Intl. (CHOICEIN)

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Call: Apr 2025

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"Choice International Limited
Q4 & FY25 Earnings Conference Call "
April 23, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. ARUN PODDAR – GROUP CHIEF EXECUTIVE
OFFICER – CHOICE INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
MR. AJAY KEJRIWAL – EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR –
CHOICE INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
MR. AYUSH SHARMA – HEAD INVESTOR RELATIONS –
CHOICE INTERNATIONAL LIMITED

MODERATOR : MRS. AASHVI SHAH – ADFACTORS PR: INVESTOR
RELATIONS

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Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Q4 & FY25 Earnings Conference Call of Choice International Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing the star, then zero on your touch-tone phone.

I now hand over the conference to Mrs. Aashvi Shah from Adfactors PR, Investor Relations. Thank you and over to you, ma'am.

Aashvi Shah: Thank you, Steve. Good evening, everyone. On behalf of Choice International, I would like to welcome you all to the maiden Earnings conference call for Q4 & FY25. Today, on this call, we have with us from the management, Mr. Arun Poddar, Group CEO, Mr. Ajay Kejriwal, Executive Director, and Mr. Ayush Sharma, Head of IR. We will begin the call with the brief opening remarks from the management followed by a Q&A session.

Please note that certain statements made during this call may be forward-looking in nature. Such forward-looking statements are subject to certain risks and uncertainties that could cause the actual results or our projections to differ materially from those statements. Choice International will not be in any way responsible for any actions taken based on such statements and undertakes no obligation to publicly update these forward-looking statements.

I would like to now hand over the call to Mr. Arun Poddar for his opening remarks. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Arun Poddar: Good evening, everyone. Thank you for joining us today for our first ever earnings conference call. We are glad to interact with each one of you today. As we step into the new financial year, we are seeing increasing signs of resilience and momentum in the Indian economy. Despite global uncertainties, domestic fundamentals remain strong backed by steady GDP growth, robust credit demand and a growing appetite of investment. The stock market too, reflects the optimism with investor confidence supported by policy reforms, rising consumption and the digital innovation.

At Choice International, we believe this is an opportune time to build on our strength and continue creating value across all our verticals. Since this is our first interaction with many of you, I would like to begin with a brief introduction to our company, our business model and the key verticals that define our operations.

Choice International Limited is a leading financial service company with over a decade of experience in delivering technology-driven financial services. We have built a diversified financial service ecosystem that caters to a broad spectrum of 13 lakh plus clients across India, ranging from retail investors to institutional clients with a strong presence in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities. Our business is structured in three verticals, each focused on creating value through specialized offerings. Let me first highlight each of these verticals :

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Broking and Distribution : The vertical contribute around 62% of our total revenue and it caters to equity broking, wealth management and the insurance distribution. Our major growth driver for this vertical has been our stockbroking business. In FY25, we have a total of 10 lakh plus Demat accounts, serving more than 2,41,000 active clients and with a total client asset of Rs. 41,000 Cr, a growth of 16% YoY basis. Under Wealth Product Distribution, we have an AUM of Rs. 5,500 Cr plus, a growth of 793% on YoY basis.

We offer a comprehensive suite of products under this business. A major milestone in this year for the business was in-principle approval from SEBI to sponsor and establish a mutual fund.

This approval allowed us to set up an asset management company and a trustee company, expanding our financial services portfolio. By entering the mutual fund industry, we aim to empower investors with tailored investment products and create value through disciplined and transparent fund management.

Another major step we have taken this year is the acquisition of Arete Capital Service, a wealth management firm with an AUM of Rs. 4,400 Cr plus. This strategic acquisition significantly improves Choice Broking's wealth business division, increasing its total AUM nearly 5-fold. The last leg of our broking and distribution is our insurance distribution arm, where our extensive network helps us cater to both retail and SME segments. Our offerings include insurance products like life insurance, health and motor.

In Q4 FY25, we have sold 52,000 plus insurance policies, generating a premium of Rs. 93 Cr. We have 40 plus partnerships with all the leading broking companies. Our POSP model is working really well for us, enabling us to expand our reach pan India. In FY25, we have 7,300 POSP registered, driving significant growth in our distribution network. We are highly optimistic about the growth potential of all the businesses within our broking and distribution arm and are actively taking the right step to scale each one of them.

Moving to our second business : NBFC. The business operates through our subsidiary Choice Finserv with a focused approach towards retail lending tailored for MSME and individuals in semi-urban and rural markets. Our portfolios span MSME business loan, vehicle loan, and solar financing, supported by tech-enabled credit assessment framework and a dedicated in-house collection team for effective risk management.

As on FY25, our total loan book stands Rs. 768 Cr with a retail loan book of Rs. 629 Cr. Our CRAR for the year stands 38.62% with a 0.83% of NNPA. Our robust underwriting process is furthered partnership with all the major banks and financial institutions, ensuring a well-diversified liability portfolio. Additionally, our proprietary app Choice Money is enabling customers to access our offerings with greater ease and efficiency.

A key highlight for the vertical this year has been the acquisition of the retail lending business of Sureworth and the Paisabuddy through a slump sale transaction. This strategic move has significantly boosted our AUM and further strengthened our position in the lending landscape. With the strong support from the government for the MSME sector, we remain highly optimistic.

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about the growth of our lending business. Our focus is on bridging the credit gap and addressing the key challenges faced by the MSME who enable their sustainable growth.

Our third and the final segment is the advisory business, which contributes 26% of our total revenue. This segment comprises of two key verticals, government advisory and the investment banking. Through our subsidiary Choice Consultancy, we offer end-to-end consulting and advisory service to the government infrastructure project.

Leveraging deep domain expertise, we support large scale initiatives across 10 states. Our robust order book, currently at Rs. 500 Cr plus, is a strong testament of our execution capability and the sectoral knowledge. We have been instrumental in delivering projects at the grassroot level, with notable work under the flagship initiatives such as Jal Jeevan Mission. With increased government focus and capital allocation for our infrastructure development, we are very well positioned to become a preferred partner for public sector projects across the country.

With the other vertical under this segment is investment banking, where we have

played a very

key role in advising a range of corporate business, corporate client and successfully executed several IPO mandate. Till now, we have concluded 6 IPO transactions successfully and 22 are ongoing mandate with a tentative fundraising pipeline of Rs. 6,450 Cr plus.

The growth of our business vertical is led by the strong foundation provided by our Choice Business Associates, who serve as a trusted partner in delivering the services across India. In FY25, I am proud to share that our CBA network has grown to over 53,000 partners, creating a

Pan-India presence and reinforcing our commitment to inclusive financial access.

Technology has always been our core for the growth strategy. Backed by a strong in-house tech team, we have successfully developed and launched platforms like Choice FinX, Choice Money and Choice Connect. These platforms are continuously upgraded with the new features, ensuring a seamless and intuitive experience of our customers and the partners. Today, our footprint spans a robust network of 192 branches and 49 project offices, supported by a dedicated team of in-house tech experts, serving a diverse and growing cliental base.

We remain committed to empowering India's aspiration by democratizing access to financial products and delivering the joy of earning through innovation, inclusion and the customer-first solution. With the deep industry expertise and the forward-looking approach, we aim to be a catalyst for growth, prosperity and positive change. Despite recent challenges, we remain in our commitment to delivering long-term value of our client, shareholder and society, guided by the principle of integrity, fairness and innovation.

Now, I would like to now hand over to Ayush Sharma, our Head of Investor Relations, who will take us through the financial performance for the quarter and the year end. Thank you.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you very much, Arun sir. While Arun sir has given a detailed understanding on each of our business verticals, I would like to take you all through the financial performance for the quarter and the year ended FY25. Choice reported a revenue of Rs. 255 Cr for Q4 FY25, a growth of 18% YoY basis. EBITDA for Q4 FY25 stood at Rs. 98.30 Cr, growth of 42% YoY. Choice International Limited

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with EBITDA margins of 38.54%. PAT for the quarter stood at Rs. 53.5 Cr, a growth of 36% YoY with PAT margins of 20.98%. This has resulted in increased margin by 277 basis points. On a full year basis, we reported a total revenue of Rs. 921.70 Cr, growth of 21% on YoY basis. EBITDA for FY25 stood at Rs. 295.90 Cr, growth of 30% on a YoY basis. EBITDA margins stood at 32.10%. Similarly, PAT for FY25 stood at Rs. 162.70 Cr, a growth of 24% on YoY basis with PAT margins of 17.65%.

On the segmental front, the broking and distribution business clocked in a total revenue of Rs. 551.20 Cr, a significant growth of 21% on a YoY basis. PBT for this vertical stood at Rs. 134.50 Cr. The NBFC business clocked in a total revenue of Rs. 114.80 Cr with PBT of Rs. 7.4 Cr. GNPA and NNPA stood at 2.49% and 0.83%, respectively, in this particular business vertical. Lastly, the advisory business had a total revenue of Rs. 250.30 Cr with PBT of Rs. 79.80 Cr. Our total debt on the book stands at Rs. 677.20 Cr as on FY25. Cash and cash equivalents for FY25 stand at Rs. 138.8 Cr.

With this, I would like to open the floor for questions.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Aayush Sharma from Alder Capital.

Aayush Sharma: Congrats on a decent set of results. I just had a couple of questions. Firstly, on physical expansion, on branches, what is the exact outlook? Secondly, how is the growth of the wealth business evolving? Finally, how will the use of technology

contribute to your growth? These are my questions.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, Aayush, for the wishes. When we started the year, we were at 115 number of branch offices. On the closing, we are at 192 branch offices. We have significantly expanded. For the upcoming financial year, we are planning to expand our branch network further by another 100 branches. On a longer term basis, if we have to take a five-year plan, we are planning to have our own branch office at almost all districts, which are roughly around 800 districts across India. There is a major reason, we are largely focusing on the branch network, because even today in the financial services space, across semi-urban geographies or Tier 3 and below geographies, whenever we talk about any financial services, the customer mindset is that they require a physical space. This we have seen across various other industries also, be it ad tech, be it the Lenskart, who started online and eventually opened a store on the ground to service to this particular customer segment. The similar thing is there for the financial services space also. We are largely bullish on the new entrants in the financial services space, which are going to come from Tier 3 and below geographies only and we will be readily available on the ground with our physical branch network for these set of customers. What was the, another question?

Aayush Sharma: Yes, it was on your wealth business and how is the business side of it? How is it working?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. On the Wealth business, we are largely focusing on the retail customers as well as the HNI and institutional clients. We had built a distribution of retail, mutual fund and wealth products with our own team. With the acquisition of Arete Capital, we have onboarded the HNI. Choice International Limited

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and institutional clients also, because the Arete's forte was on the institutional space. So we are

planning to grow on both the business models. As far as the technology is concerned, technology works as an enabler.

I would like to proudly say that our technology is no less than any other competitor in the industry. In some spaces we are even better than the competition. However, at the same time, business model largely remains on the physical presence, which is supported by the technology for the faster execution and seamless client servicing. So, that's our view on the tech part.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Raman KV from Sequent Investments . Please go ahead with your question .

Raman K V: So, first, with respect to the advisory services, we have approximately Rs. 500 Cr order book. Can you give how much of that, is from Jal Jeevan Mission and other order book of roads and highways and what is the execution timeline like?

Ayush Sharma : Okay. When it comes to the advisory order book, the tentative average timeline for execution of one project ranges from 24 to 36 months ' time. It depends what kind of services we are providing. If it is a DPR, it is completed average within 9 to 10 months' time. If it is a combination of DPR and PMC both, the average goes to 24 to 36 months' time.

We are largely focused on the mission projects of the government. If you will see our history, when we started our advisory business, roughly around 2014 -2015, the larger focus of the government was on the road and highway projects and so was the focus of our company as well. We designed and supervised more than 3000 kilometers road in the initial 2 -3 years. In the second tenure of the NDA government after 2019, the focus shifted to the Jal Jeevan Mission and that was a mission project of the central government and so was our company's focus on to the water pipeline and designing and supervision kind of projects.

We are working in sync with the government's

vision so that we are able to execute projects fast, smooth , and as per the timeline. As far as today's order book is concerned, I would say roughly around 60 % to 65% comes from water related projects and remaining 35% to 40% comes from other projects.

Raman K V: Okay, got it. So, with respect to NBFC, the book has grown by 53% like the net worth. I just want to understand what was the reason for this huge QoQ growth in the books of the NBFC business?

Ayush Sharma : Okay . In Q3 FY25 , we had acquired a retail lending business of Paisabuddy Finance Private Limited , a Jaipur based NBFC and a distribution business of Sureworth Financial Services Private Limited, another distribution company based out of Jaipur under a slump sale transaction. So, this transition has led to a significant jump into the AUM of the NBFC.

Raman Kv : Okay. Can I get the interest yield with respect to the NBFC business?

Ayush Sharma: Okay, on a consolidated book level the yield amounts to roughly around 20.5 % to 21% .
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Raman K V: Okay, and sir what is the guidance with respect to the NBFC business as well as the distribution of mutual funds business for the FY26 ?

Ayush Sharma: Our focus in the NBFC is largely on to the MSME customers in the semi -urban and rural geographies. The largest product which we do in the NBFC space is LAP, loan against properties, where the ticket size ranges from Rs. 6 lakh to Rs.8 lakh per customer. However, as we grow in size, our focus will go to prime borrowers also where the ticket size will come to somewhere around Rs. 12 lakh to Rs. 15 lakh and a slight decline in the average interest rate will also be there.

However, at the same time the distribution costs and the credit cost is also lower for that particular customer segment. So, you can expect a growth of somewhere around 25 % to 30% CAGR in the NBFC business over the couple of years. At the same time, in the NBFC, our one major focus is on to the co -lending business where we are entering into partnerships with the various banks and larger NBFCs to provide lending as a service and where we are onboarding the customer and it will be booked under the 80 -20, 90 -10 kind of ratios. So, that's more on to the NBFC business.

On the wealth space, as I had mentioned we are focusing on both retail as well as the institutional HNI customers. Our focus on the retail space is to leverage our existing branch infrastructures where we are going to utilize our existing team at the branches to distribute the mutual fund products, and other wealth -related products. On the central level, we have a dedicated team for the HNI and institutional clients. So, that 's how we are planning to grow the wealth -related business.

Raman K V: Okay. So, I have just one last question with respect to the NBFC. You mentioned that majority of the loans are LAP i.e. loan against properties . What percent of the AUM is LAP ?

Ayush Sharma: Out of around Rs. 768 Cr roughly around Rs. 430 Cr is LAP . Around Rs. 125 Cr is commercial, used commercial vehicle. The rest is solar and other loans.

Raman K V: Okay. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shubham Poruhit from SBI Securities. Please go ahead.

Shubham Poruhit: Congratulations sir on a good set of results especially in this challenging environment. So, my first question is with respect to how we are placed against competitors like Angel One and Motilal Oswal. Could you highlight what is our mode compared to these competitors?

Ayush Sharma: There is a difference of approach how we are taking the business model. We largely focus on the physical infrastructure. We largely focus on the customers who are into semi urban. Of course, digital and physical distribution have different set of challenges and different

set of

benefits. So, I would say that, we have been consistently growing over the last 6 years. Of course, with a high rate of CAGR, we have been growing roughly around 55% to 60% kind of number in the revenues and roughly around 70% in PAT. But at the same time, in the broking business we are expecting to grow at 30% to 35% kind of CAGR over the next couple of years. The Choice International Limited

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largest difference between the competitors and us, is that we prioritize the handholding of customers across their whole financial services journey, be it investments, be it the loans, be it stock market trading, etc. So, that's the kind of guidance we can give you on this question.

Shubham Poruhit: Okay. Thank you, sir. One last question, as we have seen in the recent past, the company has done a lot of acquisitions. Are we planning for more acquisitions going forward? If so, how are we planning to fund this?

Ayush Sharma: Of course, we have done a couple of acquisitions over the recent years and we intend to continue the same. There is no doubt about it. As far as the funding for the acquisitions are concerned, we have enough internal accruals to support that.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Nayan Gala from Ertiga Wealth. Please go ahead.

Nayan Gala: Thanks for the opportunity. Can you please throw some light on the advisory business? Since this is an unrelated business, it would be great if you could give some idea as to how does this business model work? How many projects in the pipeline and overall guidance for this vertical?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. I will give you a brief rework on advisory. There are two sub-segments within the advisory business, Nayan. One is the government advisory and second is the investment banking. When it comes to government advisory, we do a couple of services for the government infrastructure projects as well as financial services projects for the government.

In infrastructure, we do prepare detailed project reports. So, think of a road and highway being constructed. There is a design required to be prepared, the complete document, what will be the route, what will be the material used, what will be the cost to construct, what will be the benefit of that particular project, socio-economic impact, etc. All this information is consolidated into the Detailed Project Report, which is called as DPR. We do prepare the detailed project report, we do conduct the feasibility study and once the construction starts, we do the supervision. As you have rightly said, this is a kind of a different business than the other group businesses. However, at the same time, this diversification supports us in the challenging or turbulent times as the markets have performed not very well over the last couple of months.

However, at the same time, we have seen a surge in the government advisory business, where we were able to execute government projects and get the revenue. This is very well visible in our numbers and this balances the macroeconomic scenarios. So, that is why we are into this particular business.

Nayan Gala: Thanks, got it. Secondly, can you give some guidance on your insurance business and how are we planning to grow?

Ayush Sharma: Okay, on the insurance business part, we do both retail as well as corporate. In retail, we do largely the life, health and motor and in corporate, we do liability insurance, group mediclaim, institutional products like credit shield, etc. We have seen a very good growth over the last couple of years in the insurance business and we are very bullish that we will be able to achieve more from both the segments as we grow on the distribution space across the broking business.

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We will be able to do more cross

sell for the retail customers and for the institutional depth, we have a dedicated team here in Bombay as well as a couple of other branches also in the larger metros who are dedicatedly working with insurance companies to design the customized products for the need of large corporates. So, that is the plan to grow in the insurance business.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Swaraj Pathrey, an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Swaraj Pathrey: Sir, I wanted to ask about the advisory services business. How currently our main focus is on the broking business. Are we planning to increase the share of our advisory services business? Are we going to increase the percentage revenue from this business? About the NBFC business, are we going to increase the book?

Ayush Sharma: If I have understood correctly, Swaraj, you are asking about the contribution of each business vertical. Is that right?

Swaraj Pathrey: Yes. I just wanted to ask which part of the business we will be focusing more on?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. So, Swaraj, we are equally focusing on all business verticals. It is not that we are focused on any specific business vertical or any specific business is not of focus to us. However, at the same time, as the largest contribution to the total revenues comes from broking and distribution, we expect this to continue for the medium term.

However, at the same time, we expect that insurance distribution, as it has been growing rapidly over the couple of years, we see that in the foreseeable future, insurance will be a separate segment. There will be total four segments, broking and distribution, excluding insurance, insurance distribution, NBFC and advisory. So, that is how we are looking to grow at all our segments.

Swaraj Pathrey: Okay. Thank you so much.

Moderator: We will move on to the next question. It is from the line of Hina Parekh from Finvest First Advisors. Please go ahead.

Hina Parekh: Hello. Thank you for the opportunity, Sir. I just had a couple of questions. I will go with the first one. What are the next steps following the in-principle approval from the SEBI to launch Mutual Fund and when do we expect to begin the operation? What kind of products will you initially focus on?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. We had received the in-principle approval, I think in the month of December and we have submitted the application for the final approval. Usually, it takes 6 months time for SEBI to give the final approval after the in-principle approval. As soon as we get the final approval, we will begin with the operations. To begin with, we will be coming up with the ETF and that is going to be the first product followed by the other products.

Hina Parekh: Okay. Thank you so much. On the NBFC business side, what is the geographical split for the NBFC business? And which are the other areas that we are planning to target?

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Ayush Sharma: Currently, our NBFC operations are spread across Rajasthan, Gujarat, MP, Delhi NCR and some parts of Maharashtra. In Maharashtra, we are into MMR, Mumbai Metropolitan Region. These are the focused geographies where we have been operating and these are going to remain as focused geographies in the medium term.

Of course, we are expanding our NBFC operations. So, let us take an example; if we are operating out of town A; we choose a town B which is in the proximity of 50 kilometers from our existing branch and then we expand to that town B. This is the way we are approaching for our branch expansion in the NBFC business.

Hina Parekh: Okay. I understood. And one last question. Can you elaborate on our customer retention strategies considering the volatility in the market?

Ayush Sharma: On the customer retention part, there is a dedicated team. We work on both the models. One is physical and second is th

e digital. As majority of our customers use the mobile app called Choice

FinX to trade. There is a dedicated team in the digital team also which keep on sending the notifications, nudges, advantages to the customers of using the Choice FinX app. They work on retention part.

Secondly, we have a central team which works with the branch team to ensure the customer retention. These are done by the way of provision of the quality services, through which we put our efforts to retain the customers.

Hina Parekh: Okay. Thank you so much, sir. All the very best for the coming financial year.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions from the participants, I now hand the conference over to Mr. Arun Poddar for closing comments.

Arun Poddar: It has been great connecting with all of you as we close another strong financial year, one filled with the progress and the promises. At Choice International, our commitment to empowering communities through responsible, impactful and the financial solution, we are optimistic about the opportunities ahead, especially in the financial services space and look forward to staying in touch as your time permits.

Thank you for being part of this journey and wishing each of you continued success in the year ahead. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Choice International Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

This Transcript has been slightly edited at few places for clarity and accuracy and may contain transcription errors. The Company or the sender takes no responsibility for such errors, although an effort has been made to ensure high level of accuracy.

Call: Jul 2025

REF: CIL/CC/ 44/2025 -2026
July 28, 2025

To,
The Department of Corporate Services,
The BSE Limited,
P. J. Towers,
Dalal Street,
Mumbai - 400 001

Scrip Code: 531358 To,
The Department of Corporate Services,
The NSE Limited
5th Floor, Exchange Plaza
Plot No. C/ 1, G Block,
Bandra – Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Code: CHOICEIN

Subject: Earnings Call Transcript for Q1 and FY26 Results.

In continuation of our letter dated July 16, 2025 and Pursuant to Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 read with Regulation 46 and other applicable Regulations of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, please find the enclosed transcript of Earning conference call held by the Company on Tuesday, July 22, 2025 on Un-Audited (Standalone and Consolidated) Financial Results of the Company for the Quarter ended June 30, 2025. This information is also hosted on the Company's website:

<https://cmsapi.choiceindia.com/assets/47e6b683-1904-401c-b667-840c8833aa40>

This is for your information and record.

Thanking you,

Yours Truly,

For Choice International Limited

Karishma Shah
(Company Secretary & Compliance Officer)

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July 22, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. ARUN PODDAR – GROUP CHIEF EXECUTIVE
OFFICER – CHOICE INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
MR. AJAY KEJRIWAL – EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR –
CHOICE INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
MR. AYUSH SHARMA – HEAD INVESTOR RELATIONS –
CHOICE INTERNATIONAL LIMITED

MODERATOR : MS. AASHVI SHAH – ADFACTORS PR INVESTOR RELATIONS

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July 22, 2025

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Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Q1 FY26 Earnings Conference Call of Choice International Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star and zero on a touch -tone phone.

Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Ms. Aashvi Shah from Adfactors PR Investor Relations. Thank you and over to you.

Aashvi Shah: Thank you. Good evening everyone. On behalf of Choice International, I would like to welcome you all to the earnings conference call for Q1 F Y26. I would like to mention that the earnings presentation has been uploaded on the exchanges and the company website, so you can access it as we take you through the opening remarks.

Today on this call, we have with us from the management, Mr. Arun Poddar, Group CEO, Mr. Ajay Kejriwal, Executive Director, and Mr. Ayush Sharma, Head Investor Relations . We will begin the call with brief opening remarks from the management, followed by a Q&A session. Please note that certain statements made during this call may be forward -looking in nature. Such forward -looking statements are subject to certain risks and uncertainties that could cause the actual results or our projections to differ materially from those statements. Choice International will not be in any way responsible for any actions taken based on such statements and undertakes no obligation to publicly update these forward -looking statements.

I would like to now hand over the call to Mr. Arun Poddar for his opening remarks. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Arun Poddar: Thank you, Aashvi. Good evening, everyone. Thank you for joining us today for Q1 F Y26 earnings conference call. We are glad to interact with each one of you today. As F Y26 takes shape, we are seeing a steady improvement in the economic environment. The first quarter reflected a gradual pick -up in market sentiment, supported by RBI's rate cut, stable macro indicator and a supportive global context. Foreign portfolio flow has started to return and retail participation has remained constant, leading to a broad -based recovery. This provides a stable backdrop as we continue to focus on our priorities for the year ahead.

Choice began F Y26 on a strong note, building on a strong momentum we achieved last year. This quarter, we saw encouraging progress across all our business verticals, driven by our commitment to operational excellence and customer centric growth. During the quarter, Choice reported revenue of Rs. 238 Cr, with a PAT of Rs. 48 Cr; reflecting the strength of our diversified business model . I am particularly pleased that we have expanded our branch network to 208, up from 149 a year ago, reflecting our intent to strengthen our presence and better serve our clients across the country.

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I also wanted to highlight our order win this quarter under our consulting business. We secured a project worth Rs. 63.5 Cr across Maharashtra and Odisha, including a Rs. 52.8 Cr World Bank -backed Maharashtra Government project, to set up a district strategic unit in Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar Division over 5 years, enhancing data -driven, growth -focused governance. Additionally, we won a new mandate worth nearly Rs. 67 Cr for large -scale digitization across Bihar, Karnataka, and under the mandated Bharat Net program, expanding our work in P ACS computerization and rural broadband connectivity. This will align with our mission to deliver technology -enabled, impact -driven solutions that empower communities

and support India's inclusive growth.

Looking ahead, we remain focused on strengthening our client relationship, expanding our presence, and leveraging technology to deliver seamless financial services . We are committed to driving sustainable growth while creating meaningful impact across the communities we serve. With confidence in our strategy and the dedication of our team, we look forward to

delivering consistent value of our stakeholder in the times to come.

With this, I would like to invite our Executive Director, Mr. Ajay Kejriwal, to take you through the business highlights for the quarter. Over to Ajay Sir.

Ajay Kejriwal: Good evening, everybody. Myself, Ajay Kejriwal. At Choice, the first quarter of FY26 has been steady progress across our businesses. This reflects the strength of our business model and the consistent efforts of our teams, along with our ongoing investments in technology and people. Our broking and distribution business, which contributes 60% of our total revenue, continues to demonstrate healthy traction. During the quarter, the number of demat accounts stood at 11.5 lakh, recording a growth of 29% on a YoY basis, driven by our digital onboarding capabilities, consistent client engagement, and comprehensive product offerings. The total client assets in our stock broking business reached Rs. 47,800 Cr, a growth of 16% YoY, while our wealth products AUM stood at Rs. 4,769 Cr, making a growth of 443% YoY.

Focusing next on our NBFC business, we remained committed to support the aspirations of MSMEs and retail borrowers across semi-urban and rural India, while maintaining a disciplined approach to risk. At the end of Q1 FY26, our total loan book stood at Rs. 745 Cr, with the retail loan book at Rs. 596 Cr. We continue to maintain healthy asset quality, with NNPA as of June 2025 at 2.25%. Leveraging our Choice Money app, along with our physical network, has enabled us to enhance customer accessibility and operational efficiency, supporting the steady and prudent expansion of our lending portfolio.

Our Advisory business, which contributed 24% of our total revenue during the quarter, continues to build on its strong execution track record. The order book for the Advisory segment stood at Rs. 586 Cr at the end of the quarter, reflecting our domain expertise and strong on-ground execution. During the quarter, our Advisory firm Choice Consultancy Services secured significant mandates that further strengthen our leadership in driving digital and public sector transformation across India. These were highlighted earlier by Arun. We are very optimistic on

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more order wins coming our way and our resilience and efforts have definitely worked well for us.

On the investment banking side, we continue to support corporates in their fundraising journey, leveraging our expertise and strong execution capabilities. Till now, we have concluded 7 IPO transactions successfully and 24 are ongoing mandates with a tentative fundraising pipeline of Rs. 6,600 Cr plus.

A key strength for Choice remains our Choice Business Associate network, which has now grown to over 58,000 associates, playing a critical role in expanding our reach across India and enabling us to deliver financial services seamlessly across diverse geographies. This network aligns with our commitment to financial inclusion and our mission of enabling community-centric growth.

At Choice, technology remains central to our growth strategy. Our in-house tech teams continue to enhance platforms like Choice FinX, Choice Money and Choice Connect, ensuring seamless experiences for our clients and partners while supporting the scalability and operational resilience of our busi-

nesses. With 208 branches and 48 project offices and a team of in-house tech specialists, we are serving a diverse and expanding client base across the country.

As we move forward, our focus will remain on delivering consistent value to our stakeholders.

We will continue to adapt, innovate and execute with discipline as we navigate the evolving landscape with our strong foundation. We are well-placed to build on this progress and shape the next phase of our journey.

With this, I would like to hand over to Ayush Sharma, our Head of Investor Relations, to take you through our financial performance for the quarter. Thank you.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you very much, Sir. While Arun sir and Ajay sir have provided a detailed overview of each of our business verticals, I will now take you through our financial performance for Q1 FY26.

Choice reported revenue of Rs. 238 Cr for Q1 FY26, marking a healthy growth of 16% on a YoY basis. Our EBITDA for the quarter stood at Rs. 87 Cr, reflecting a robust growth of 49% YoY, while the EBITDA margins improved to 36.48%. PAT for the quarter came in at Rs. 48 Cr, registering a growth of 50% YoY, resulting in a PAT margin of 20.16%. This has led to a notable improvement in margins by 462 basis points YoY, underscoring our focus on operational efficiencies and prudent cost management.

On the segmental front, our Broking and Distribution business recorded a total revenue of Rs. 136 Cr, reflecting a strong growth of 5% YoY, with PBT for the segment at Rs. 30 Cr, demonstrating the resilience and scalability of our platform-led approach. In our NBFC business,

we reported a revenue of Rs. 39 Cr, with PBT at Rs. 7 Cr. Asset quality in this segment remains stable. Lastly, our Advisory business reported a revenue of Rs. 60 Cr, with PBT at Rs. 24 Cr, supported by a strong order book and execution of key mandates across services.

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With that, I would now like to open the floor for Q&A.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the Q&A session. The first question is from the line of Jai Chauhan from Trinetra Asset Managers.

Jai Chauhan: I just had a question. How much in -capital revenue are you expecting per new branch and what is the revenue per branch at FY25 and what is the target for FY26 for revenue per branch? If you track that, can you please give some insights on that?

Ayush Sharma: It all depends on the seasoning of the branch, how much know vintage has been there for a branch. Of course, we track the profitability at each branch level. From the revenue perspective, it will largely depend on the seasoning.

Based on the geography of the branch, there are various categories for each branch, A, B, C, D, etc. Accordingly, the revenues vary from geography to geography. On a general mindset, to comment on, there is a six-month timeline for a branch to reach break-even levels.

Jai Chauhan: Understood. Actually, I wanted to get more insights on the unit economics. But since, as you mentioned, I just wanted to get more insights on what is the product mix like broking, lending versus bank you are seeing from these newer locations compared to your more established ones?

Arun Poddar: Our major revenue contributor is as on date equity only. If you see our branches, almost 85% revenue comes from the broking business, 10% comes from the wealth product and 5% only from the lending side. Our NBFC branches more or less are independent branches and equity branches sell more or less all the products. So, revenue contribution is 80% from the broking and distribution, around 15% from the wealth product and balance from others.

Jai Chauhan: Understood. So, NBFC branches are independent and the rest of the branches shares all the services, right?

Ayush Sharma: Yes. That's right.

Jai Chauhan

an: Got it. Just one last question. What are some digital marketing strategies that you are doing to onboard Tier 3 clients? Do you have any comments on that?

Ayush Sharma: Largely, so far, we have been onboarding Tier -3 and Tier-4 clients by way of our physical approach, where we onboard branches, we do ground-level marketing, and onboard customers from these clusters. Of course, yes, we do have a digital marketing team, but the overall contribution of digital marketing is quite low at the moment. The largest contributor is the physical expansion of our branches.

Jai Chauhan: Got it. That's all from my side. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mandira from Invesco. Please go ahead.

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Mandira: Thank you for the opportunity. I have two questions. Your revenue grew by 16% YoY, but there is a decline in QoQ. Is this a seasonal or one-off event, and what led to the dip?

Ayush Sharma: This is a general trend in business because Q4 is always heavy because of various contests and various other business growth activities which we do in Q4. Moreover, generally, in the investment segment also, people tend to plan their investments in Q4 because of tax planning as well. These are the kinds of reasons why Q4 is higher and Q1 is usually lower. So, it's a cyclical kind of thing. There is no one-off event in this particular quarter.

Mandira: Got it, sir. What's the growth roadmap and which vertical will be the key focus area in the coming future?

Ayush Sharma: On the growth perspective, we expect on a YoY basis is to maintain a healthy growth rate of around 25% to 30% for the next 3-4 years. On the business verticals perspective, we foresee broking continue to grow as it is growing, as well as insurance increasing their contribution in the overall broking segment. We have recently acquired Arete Capital, which has a larger expertise in wealth management space. So, we expect that segment also as coming out as a separate vertical out of the broking segment.

Mandira: Got it, sir. That was really helpful.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nakul Dev from ND Investments. Please go ahead.

Nakul Dev: Thank you for the opportunity. First of all, congratulations on a very good set of numbers. I had a couple of questions regarding the consultancy business which is doing quite well. Firstly, the advisory segment order book stood at Rs. 586 Cr. Can you share the execution time period and revenue conversion plans for this order book? Also, this quarter we have won two orders worth Rs. 63.5 Cr, including the World Bank -backed MahaSTRIDE project and a top -rank bid in Odisha. If you could elaborate on the nature of these projects and their potential margins and execution time line. Do we have plans to demerge this vertical going forward? These are my questions.

Arun Poddar: Nakul, as far as revenue is concerned for Rs. 586 Cr order book, normally it takes around 24 to 36 month time to book the revenue. In terms of Maharashtra and Odisha project s time line, \Maharashtra project will take 5 years of time as it's a 60 month project and Odisha is 2 year project. So, total revenue for Maharashtra project will be booked in next 5 year time and Odisha project will take around 2 to 3 year time.

As far as the demerge r of this activity is concerned, as of now, it's not in our plan. We are purely focusing on business growth and g etting the major numbers. As of now, there is no plan in terms of demerger or disengaged services. As far as margin is concerned, in gov ernment advisory practice, our margin s are around 22% to 25% tentatively and it' takes almost 2 to 3 years time to book the revenue.

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Nakul Dev: Okay. Ye s. That answers my questions for now. If t

here's anything else, I'll get back into the question queue. T hank you.

Arun Poddar: Thank s, Nakul .

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nikit a Shah, an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Nikita Shah: Yes. Thanks for the opportunity. I have one question. I actually wanted to understand the way forward for the stock broking business. There is a lot of competition now from discount brokers and even other large traditional brokers. So, how do we plan to grow this vertical and retain our clients and also expand or get more clients on this?

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, Nikita, for asking this question. This is very important to understand that, as you rightly pointed out, there are discount brokers, physical brokers, full -service brokers like us, as well as the bank brokers in the market. As the regul ator has started being more strict on the compliance perspective, the cost of operation for the discount brokers has started increasing. We have seen instances where discount brokers have also started increasing the charges. So, this clearly lays out the w ay forward that ultimately everybody will start charging the cost. Now, it will be the game of service who is providing what level of service to the client, especially in the Tier 3 and Tier 4 geographies. We foresee a very healthy competition, if a discou nt broker also starts moving towards the physical kind of model. But until then, we don't see any particular challenge in our healthy growth, or we foresee to grow continuously as we are doing over the last five years.

Nikita Shah : Yes. Okay. In the insura nce broking business , how do we account for the income from this business? Is it commission -based or what is the percentage we get here? How do we share it with the brokers?

Ayush Sharma: In case of insurance , we do get payout fr om the insurance companies. That's the revenue for the insurance broking company. Also, there are certain POSPs through which we do originate clients and there are revenue sharing arrangements for each POSP , depending on the level of business they are orig inating.

Nikita Shah : Okay. Got it. Lastly, what is the status of the AMC business? We have got approval from SEBI to launch the mutual fund ; when can we expect the operations to begin? Any products you have in mind, i nitially what focus will you have?

Arun Poddar: Nikita, last week the final visit was done by SEBI for the final approval . Initially, we got the in -principal approval from the SEBI. We are expecting the final go ahead from the next one -month time tentatively. Before Diwali, tentatively, we are planning to launch our first fund.

Nikita Shah : Okay.

Arun Poddar: Initially targeting ETF fund only.

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Nikita Shah: Okay. Thank you, sir. That will be all from my side.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shashank Venugopal from Venugopal Family Office. Please go ahead.

Shashank Venugopal: Thanks for the opportunity. Can you elaborate on the Choice Business Associates network? We have not seen something like this in other brokers. I just wanted to understand how this works. Do we give them a fixed commission or how it works? How do we manage receivables from the government business?

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, Shashank, for joining in. We started this network in 2019 and our larger focus is again in Tier 3 and below geographies where we onboard Choice Business Associates. Think of a situation of a Tier 3 city where one individual is doing a practice of, let's say, GST consulting. He has clients for whom he is filing the GST returns. Now, we onboard them as CBA. We train him and we equip him to be able to sell the financial services products, and he starts selling these products to his existing clients and gradually starts onboarding new clients. This is just one of

the examples.

Think of a scenario where there are insurance agents in these kinds of geographies. We onboard them as CBAs and train them to sell other products also, including demat accounts, including mutual funds, SIPs, etc. So, these are the kinds of examples who are the CBAs and working for us. We onboard them, train them and equip them to sell other financial services products and this helps them to grow their own revenues as well as grow the business for us.

There are various levels for which the CBAs are working on. According to their level of business, there is a specific payout percentage for each product specifically. Let's say, there is level A, which is on the top, and level C, which is the number 3. So, payout for level C will be different, level A will be different. This way we are growing this particular distribution network.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Nayan Gala from Ertica Wealth. Please go ahead.

Nayan Gala: Thank you for the opportunity. Just had a couple of questions. One was from the NBFC business point of view, just wanted to understand on the outlook of the business. Also, which states we are currently present in and how do we plan to expand our reach in terms of the number of states? What is the strategy to acquire more clients under this vertical?

Ayush Sharma: Currently, we are operating across Rajasthan, Gujarat, MP, Delhi NCR, and some part of Maharashtra as well. There are 75 branches across all these states through which we are doing the business in the NBFC vertical. In NBFC, there are three major products where we are focusing on.

First and foremost is the MSME focused Micro LAP where the average ticket size is around Rs. 8 to 9 lakh and average rate of interest which we are charging is around 20%, 20.5%, 21% kind of number. Second is rooftop solar and third is vehicle. So, these three products contribute largest to our current AUM.

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As far as the customer acquisition strategy is concerned, we work on a physical branch-led model where we have the on-ground sales team who reaches out to the customers, check their interest. If the customers are interested, we do their onboarding through our online mobile app. From there, the complete underwriting is done, credit assessment is done at the ground level as well as the central level. Basis that a final sanction is given and disbursement happens through the digital channels only. So, this is the overall model in the NBFC.

As far as the growth is concerned, this year we are planning to stay focused on these 75 branches only. Our target is to grow the AUM in these particular branches. As we have the adequate amount of AUM from these branches, we will expand more branches in these states as well as expand to newer states next year onwards.

Nayan Gala: So, at present you would like to focus on the areas that you are already present in. That's the correct understanding.

Ayush Sharma: Yes, right.

Nayan Gala: Also, in terms of the offerings, you will stick to the three offerings that you have currently?

Ayush Sharma: That's right.

Nayan Gala: On the next question, Choice has significantly expanded its operation over the last three years.

So, what is the strategy from here? How do we plan to expand from here? Are we targeting Tier 1 states or are we focused on Tier 2 and Tier 3? Which vertical do we plan to expand first?

Ayush Sharma: Nayan, as you must have seen in our earnings presentation also, almost 70% of our customers are from Tier 3 and below geographies. So, our largest focus remains on Tier 3 and below geographies and that's where we are planning to expand over the next couple of years as well.

As far as the verticals are concerned, we are equally focused across all our verticals and we are working on

a multidimensional growth plan where on one side we are expanding our investment banking business also. We have been engaged in the seven IPOs over the last one and a half year time and there are 24 more mandates which are there in the pipeline where we are going to act as a lead merchant banker.

Similarly, on the wealth side, as I had mentioned that last quarter, we had acquired a retail capital and through that we plan to expand our institutional wealth, HNI and UHNI segment and wealth management practice as well. On NBFC and insurances we have already spoken. We are working on all these segments with equal focus and we target to grow all these verticals equally.

Nayan Gala: Okay, thank you. Lastly on the outlook for the industry, if you have any views or some points that can help us understand about the growth the industry can see in the near future?

Ayush Sharma: I would request Ajay sir to throw some lights on the industry. Nayan, you are asking about broking industry as specifically or NBFC?

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Nayan Gala: Yes, broking industry in particular?

Ajay Kejriwal: Nayan, broking industry as a strategy, as Ayush has already told about that we are expanding on the physical branches network and we see that we will gain a benefit of physical branches having a trust factor in that. For that we are going on events also on ground with the Zee business and other media platforms.

From the industry perspective as such, the growth will be continued. The only thing is the factors which are changing due to the regulations and public perception. We see consolidation will happen and shift will happen in the discount model as we discussed. It will help players like us to boost more in this business and in growth perspective we don't see any challenge. Though it will be a little bit more standardized and commoditized business, but growth opportunities are huge and we see a healthy growth in coming. Short terms, measures can be happened like Jane Street or any other event might happen, but in the longer run we see a good opportunity.

Nayan Gala: Sir, any merger or acquisition plans under this?

Ajay Kejriwal: Yes. We are always looking forward to it. So, if anything materializes, or some conclusion will happen, we will let you know. We will go for the disclosure on the exchange. We are actively looking for it.

Nayan Gala: Okay.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Manoj Rajani from Rajani Family Office.

Manoj Rajani: Good evening. Sir, just had three questions. First one is, what is the current breakdown between retail and institutional clients, and what was it last time that will give the comparison?

Ayush Sharma: The current revenue which is coming from retail amounts to around 93% to 94% and institutional is around 6% to 7%. The institutional business has expanded from the last year by 100 to 200 bps on a rough estimate.

Manoj Rajani: Okay. That's very nice. Second question would be what would be the brokerage charges and do they vary by customer segment?

Ayush Sharma: The brokerage is 0.02% and 0.20% for cash and delivery, and these are standardized, fixed. For delivery and intraday, depends on the segment, and these are the basic pricing, and it will vary depending on the client segment.

Manoj Rajani: All right, sir. That gives quite a lot of clearance. Lastly would like to ask what are we doing with the F&O as an offering and what is the brokerage we charge there?

Ayush Sharma: On the F&O brokerage part, we charge on each lot and it is Rs. 20 per lot on the options piece.

Manoj Rajani: Okay, sir. That's very nice. How do we manage the receivables from the government business?

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Ayush Sharma: As a focus, we largely work on the mission projects of the Central

Government. To give you a

background, when we started consulting in the advisory business, we started with the NHAI projects where we used to prepare DPRs for road and highway projects, because in the first tenure of NDA government, larger focus was on roads and highways. Second was Jal Jeevan Mission where we also worked quite aggressively on the Jal Jeevan Mission projects.

Now, as the focus is still continuing on both the segment and additional focus is moving towards railways, ports, telecommunication kind of sector. So, we are also expanding towards those sectors. The good part about these mission projects is that the target of government is to complete these projects on a fast track timeline. So, the payments are also on a fast track mode. We don't see major challenge in the receivable management from the government in this segment. Manoj,

I hope this was helpful.

Manoj Rajani: Yes, sir. That was more than helpful, sir. I'll be joined back in the queue later on.

Ayush Sharma: Okay.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Rahil from Crown Capital.

Rahil: Hi. Just one question, if you could just elaborate and explain a bit about your plans about the insurance business, what stage that it is according to you and anything new you're focusing on over there?

Ayush Sharma: For insurance, there are two segments on which we are working on. One is corporate and the second is retail. We have dedicated teams who are specifically focused on corporate, as well as retail. We foresee a huge opportunity in both segments equally. However, the corporate is more lucrative for us. So, we are expecting to grow higher in the corporate insurance piece as well along with the focus on the retail insurance.

So, take an example. There are specific clusters of industrial zones across India. We are expanding to those industrial zones where we can reach out to those customers, those larger corporates who are having large setups for their insurance needs. That's one of the expansion strategies which we are adopting to grow the corporate insurance business.

Rahil: Okay. As mentioned earlier, you expect to maintain this 25% or 30% growth rate for the next three years to four years, you meant overall for the business, at consolidated level right?

Ayush Sharma: Yes. That's right.

Rahil: Okay. Just lastly, with that kind of a growth rate, what are your plans to support your EBITDA margins? You have been doing well for the past three years from 27% to 31%. So, any room for improvement there, and if so, how?

Ayush Sharma: On the margins front, Rahil, one thing is that all our operations are digitized. There is no manual operations we are into. Everything is tech driven. Everything is system driven. So, the opex does not increase directly in sync with the growth in revenues in our majority of businesses. So, we

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expect that margins will although remain at the similar levels, however, there is still room for a little improvement. That we will be leveraging upon.

Rahil: So, that improvement will be simply tech driven or is there any other leeway for that?

Ayush Sharma: Actually, it will be tech driven.

Moderator: I now hand the conference over to Mr. Arun Poddar for closing comments.

Arun Poddar: Thank you for joining us today. The first quarter has set a steady start to the year, and we remain focused on maintaining this momentum while serving our customer and building on our strength.

We value your continued interest in Choice International Limited and appreciate the trust you place in us.

We look forward to connecting with you again next quarter and if anyone wants to connect one on one, we are very much positive. Wishing you all a very good day ahead. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Choice International Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us

and you may now disconnect your line.

(This document has been edited for readability purposes.)

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“Choice International Limited
Q2 & H1 FY26 Earnings Conference Call ”
October 17, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. ARUN PODDAR – GROUP CHIEF EXECUTIVE
OFFICER – CHOICE INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
MR. AJAY KEJRIWAL – EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR –
CHOICE INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
MR. AYUSH SHARMA –HEAD, INVESTOR RELATIONS –
CHOICE INTERNATIONAL LIMITED

MODERATOR : MS. FORUM GOSHAR – ADFACTORS PR INVESTOR
RELATION

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Mod erator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Choice International Limited Q2 & H1FY26 Earnings Conference Call . As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone.

Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Ms. Forum Gosh ar from Ad factors PR. Thank you and over to you ma'am.

Forum Goshar: Good evening everyone. On behalf of Choice International, I would like to welcome you all to the Earnings Conference Call for Q2 & H1 FY26. I would like to mention that the earnings presentation has been uploaded on the exchanges and the company website. So, you can access it as we take you through the opening remarks and the call. Joining us today from the management of Choice International Limited are Mr. Arun Poddar - Group CEO, Mr. Ajay Kejriwal - Executive Director and Mr. Ayush Sharma - Head of Investor Relations. We will begin the call with brief opening remarks from the management followed by a Q&A session.

Please note that certain statements made during this call may be forward looking in nature. Such forward looking statements are subject to certain risks and uncertainties that could cause the actual results or our projections to differ materially from those statements. Choice International will not be in any way responsible for any actions taken based on such statements and undertakes no obligation to publicly update these forward looking statements.

I would like to hand over the call to Mr. Arun Poddar for his opening remarks. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Arun Poddar: Thank you. Forum . Good evening everyone and a warm welcome to our Q2 & H1FY26 Earning Conference Call. It is a pleasure to have you all with us today . The first half of FY26 has been marked by continuing economic resilience driven by strong domestic consumption, healthy investment activity and steady government expenditure. The inflation trajectory remained favorable, supported by effective GST reforms, while liquidity condition and the external sector performance stayed stable. Financial market too have reflected this underlying strength and confidence. Against this macro-economic backdrop, we remain focus on driving sustainable growth across all our businesses in the second half of the year .

FY26 has been a year of steady progress so far with Choice delivering another strong performance in Q2 & H1FY26. The first half saw consistent growth across all business segments reflecting our disciplined execution, operational excellence and the customer -first approach. For H1 FY26, Choice reported revenue of Rs. 522 Cr and a PAT of Rs. 104 Cr, reaffirming the strength of our diversified business model. During the quarter, we also strengthened our investment banking division by successfully completing five new IPOs, raising Rs. 990 Cr for clients and further enhancing our presence in the capital market.

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The group also achieved two key milestones that further enhanced our diversified financial service presence. Choice AMC Pvt. Ltd., our wholly owned subsidiary, received the final SEBI approval to operate as an asset management company for Choice Mutual Fund, marking the group's formal entry into the investment management space. Leveraging its pan -India reach and tech-led distribution, Choice Mutual Fund aims to bridge the gap between traditional advice and the modern investment solution.

In addition, Choice Consultancy Service Pvt. Ltd. secured project mandate worth Rs. 140 Crores across

sectors such as housing, agriculture, MSME and urban planning, highlighting its position as a trusted partner for high -impact development initiatives nationwide.

As we move forward in the second half of FY26, our focus remains on deepening client engagement and exploring new growth opportunities to enhance efficiency and service delivery. With our team effort and a clear strategy, we aim to deliver consistent value to our stakeholders in the months ahead.

Our broking and distribution business, contributing 59% to total revenue, has continued to show strong growth. Total client asset under management in our stock broking segment reaches Rs. 57,600 Cr for Q2 FY26, reflecting a YoY growth of 25% ; while AUM for our wealth product rose to Rs. 4,807 Cr, up 327% YoY. The number of Demat accounts grew to 12,05,000, a YoY increase of 29% supported by our onboarding capabilities, consistent client engagement and a wide range of product offerings.

Moving on to the insurance distribution business, it continues to grow steadily, driven by an expanding distribution network and higher digital adoption among the clients. During the quarter, insurance premium reaches Rs. 66 Cr, up 2% YoY with 68,896 policies sold. Turning to our NBFC business, which contributes 15%, we continue to support MSME and the retail borrower across semi -urban and rural India with a disciplined risk management approach. At the end of H1 FY26, our total loan book stood Rs. 716 Cr, with retail segment contributing Rs. 536 Cr. Asset quality remains healthy with NNPA at 2.79% as on Sept 30, 2025. By combining our Choice Money App with our physical branch network, we have improved customer accessibility and operational efficiency, enabling steady and prudent growth of our lending portfolio.

Our advisory business contributing 26% of total revenue in this quarter, continues to build its strong execution capabilities. The advisory order book stood at Rs. 666 Cr at the end of this quarter. Reflecting our domain expertise and effective on -ground delivery, during this period, Choice Consultancy Service secured several significant mandates, further reinforcing our leadership across multiple sectors in India.

In our investment banking business, we remain focused on assisting corporates with their capital raising needs, drawing on our execution experience and sector expertise. So far, we have successfully completed 12 IPO transactions, while 27 mandates are currently in progress with a tentative fundraising pipeline exceeding Rs. 7,000 Cr.

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A key strength of Choice continues to be our Choice Business Associate Network, now over 63,000, helping us expand our reach across India. Technology remains central to our growth, with in -house teams enhancing platforms like Choice FinX , Choice Money and Choice Connect to ensure seamless client and partner experience. Supported by 211 branches, 49 project offices and our tech specialists, we are effectively serving our expanding and diverse client base nationwide.

As we look forward, our priority will be strengthening our businesses, exploring new opportunities and continuing delivering meaningful outcomes for our stakeholders. I will now

hand over to Ayush Sharma, our Head of Investor Relations, who will walk you through the financial performance of the quarter. Over to Ayush Sharma .

Ayush Sharma: Thank you very much, Arun sir. While Arun sir has already shared a comprehensive overview of our business verticals, I will now take you through our financial performance for Q2 and H1 FY26.

For Q2 FY26, Choice reported consolidated revenue of Rs. 284 Cr, reflecting a healthy Y oY growth of 14%. EBITDA for the quarter stood at Rs. 99 Cr, with margins improving to 34.84%, demonstrating our continue

d focus on operational efficiency. PAT for the quarter came in at Rs.

56 Cr, resulting in a PAT margin of 19.87% and a Y oY growth of 22%.

For H1 FY26, the company recorded a total revenue of Rs. 522 Cr, which is up by 15% on a YoY basis. EBITDA for the first half reached Rs. 186 Cr, with margins at 35.59%, while PAT stood at Rs. 104 Cr, reflecting a Y oY increase of 33%. This performance underscores our consistent execution across all businesses and the strength of our scalable operating model. Looking at our business segments, the Broking and Distribution vertical reported Q2 revenue of Rs. 161 Cr, with PBT at Rs. 43 Cr. The growth reflects both increased client participation and higher assets under management across our stock broking and wealth businesses. In our NBFC segment, Q2 revenue was Rs. 43 Cr, with PBT at Rs. 4 Cr. The combination of digital platforms and our physical network continue to enhance reach and operational efficiency. Asset quality in this segment remains stable.

Our Advisory business delivered Q2 revenue of Rs. 79 Cr and PBT of Rs. 28 Cr, driven by strong order execution across sectors ; supported by strong order book and high quality execution reinforces our position as a trusted advisor across multiple sectors in India.

With that, I would now like to open the floor for Q&A.

Moderator: Thank you very much, sir. The first question comes from the line of Bimal Panchal from Bimal Panchal & Associates. Please go ahead.

Bimal Panchal: Good afternoon. At the outset, heartiest congratulations for a robust performance and very good optimism you have given in this opening speech. I don't have much question s, but just wanted

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to know what is the scope of the Choice Consultancy Service and the scope of activities in this Rs. 140 Cr worth projects ? What we are going to do?

Ayush Sharma: Thank you for joining in. Basically, in Choice Consultancy, there are various advisory services largely concentrated towards the government clients, where we assist government in execution of various infrastructure and non -infrastructure projects.

There are projects where we assist various state governments in developing the MSME sector for the state. For example, government has engaged Choice Consultancy Service to conduct financial awareness programs across states for the MSME sector ; specifically, on how the MSMEs can take the benefit of various government schemes which are specifically aligned towards the credit availability to the MSMEs and various subsidies which are being made available by the government to the MSMEs. We conduct such programs across states and conduct this financial awareness drive where we invite the MSMEs, train them on various credit schemes, as well as subsidy schemes available to the MSMEs specifically from the state, as well as the central government and then assist them in obtaining those services as well. This is one of the examples of a project.

There are another project of project management units also where government executes large programs across states, as well as multi -state programs are also conducted by the central government. We act as the project management unit for those larger programs and provide the complete hand -holding to the government with the monthly, weekly, quarterly updates on the projects and ensuring the timely completion of those projects. So . these are the kind of projects which we conduct in line along with the government across India.

Bimal Panchal: Okay. Thank you, sir. One more question for Choice AMC, what is the likely date of launching our mutual funds and what kind of a scheme that we are going to do ? Are we doing all kinds of mutual schemes or some hedge funds or pricing funds ? What kind of scope we are going

to

launch?

Ayush Sharma: In Q3, we are launching Gold ETF and the date for the first NFO is 24th of October 2025. In the next quarter, we are planning to go for Silver ETF and in FY 27, we will come up with the passive strategies, as well as active strategies both. So . that is the way forward on the timelines.

Obviously, these timelines are subject to various market factors and the regulatory approvals which are required.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Rahul Sharma with Finvest.

Rahul Sharma: I just want to know , what is your vision for the AMC business that we have recently got the license for and how are we planning to enter the market with already established players? A follow -up question to that like can you just elaborate on the strategy further as in what kind of AUM are you targeting from the Gold ETF this year?

Ayush Sharma : I request Ajay Sir to take up this question, please.

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Ajay Kejriwal: Yes, Good evening. As per the target of the Gold ETF, initially we are targeting at least around Rs. 200 Cr in NFO and then as the market grows and we penetrate to the branch network and digital marketing channels, we'll expand this going forward.

Rahul Sharma: Okay, sir. Thank you so much. That was it from my side.

Ayush Sharma: Okay . Thank you, Rahul.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the lin e of Urmish Shah from Moneywisers . Please go ahead.

Urmish Shah: Yes, I had one question on the insurance business. If I see your presentation in the corporate vertical, we have seen a decline YoY of 31%. Any reason could you give?

Ayush Sharma: Corporate business is with limited number of clients and there has been one contract which we could not renew during the quarter because of which we have seen a decline ; but on an overall strategy perspective, when we look our pipeline for the further corporate policies which we are going to issue and where we are at the advanced stage, we are very much confident that we will fill this gap in the Q3 FY2 6 in the corporate insurance.

Urmish Shah: Okay. In the NBFC business also a slight drop in NIM has been observed. Is this NIM margin maintainable for the full year?

Ayush Sharma: On the NBFC, the NIM has slightly dropped largely because we have not been doing the unsecured loans where higher rate of interest is earned. Largely , our focus is on the secured loan portfolio which has lower rate of interest. So, because of which there has been a slight reduction. However, we are hopeful that we will be able to maintain 10% - 11% kind of NIM numbers in the medium term timelines.

Urmish Shah: Right . One final question, Sir. The revenue per branch for H1, if you could give some color?

Ayush Sharma: We have the revenue numbers and we have the branches numbers as we ll. I do not have that number handy with me right now.

Urmish Shah: Okay. Since in the presentation it is mentioned that we are going to open 100 new branches by end of FY26, where we are currently standing after H1 and how is it going forward, the pipeline?

Ayush Sharma: Specifically on the broking business, we have opened 35 new branches during this particular half of the year. We are very much on track to complete the 100 new branches target for this remaining half of the year. I mean the 100 total for this financial year.

Urmish Shah: Yes. Okay, Sir. Thank you and all the best.

Ayush Sharma: Thanks a lot.

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Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Jayshree Bajaj with Trinetra Asset Managers . Please go ahead.

Jayshree Bajaj: Good afternoon, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. My question is the company secured new strategic projects worth Rs. 1,303 Mn in Q1 FY26, including the MahaSTRIDE Program in Maharashtra and mandates for PACS in

Bihar and Karnataka. What is the anticipated revenue recognition timeline for these specific projects and how will they enhance future recurring business?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. These projects have an average timeline of 24 months to 36 months' time . So, this revenue will be staggered over the 24 months to 36 months timeline . All these projects have a mixed kind of invoicing pattern where we are eligible to raise some amount as monthly invoicing and some are milestone based invoicing. However, the complete project cycle is 24 months to 36 months ' time where these will be completed and complete revenue will be recognized as revenue in our profit and loss account. Moreover, on the pipeline perspective, we have already bid on multiple projects, similar projects, where we are expecting the outcomes of tenders during Q3. We are hopeful that we'll keep on adding to our overall order book during this quarter and the next quarter as well.

Jayshree Bajaj: Thank you, Sir. That's all from my side.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Shreyansh an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Shreyansh: Hi, everyone. Congrats on the quarter. My question was on the brokerage front. From an industry perspective, what more could get worse from here ; say weekly expiring pending could be one. What else could go wrong? We also saw Nithin Kamath also voicing his concerns on the same. If you could also highlight what the corresponding impact on Choice can be?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. From the Choice 's perspective first, we are largely on to retail segment. Specifically in retail , we have a higher cash contribution instead of derivatives contribution when we compare ourselves to the industry numbers , because of which we do not foresee a major impact of the regulatory changes.

Of course, there are certain impact in the overall industry and we will also face certain headwinds. However, we are very much confident that we will be at a better position compared to the industry while looking at our business model.

Shreyansh: Just as a follow up there, what else do you think could get bad from here, from an industry perspective?

Ayush Sharma: I mean, we don't foresee anything going wrong from here. It's only a positive upward trend which we foresee from here.

Shreyansh: Got it. Thanks.

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Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Mandira with Investo . Please go ahead.

Mandira: Thank you for the opportunity, sir. The NB FC business is growing very rapidly. How are we managing collection when entire industry is suffering?

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, Mandira . In the NB FC specifically we have a dedicated in -house collections team. So, our business is also on the physical model where we have the physical branches and we source the clients through physical branches channel only. Therefore, it is inevitable that we have a physical collections team as well on the ground, which is completely in -house, where we keep a close track to ensure the timely collections.

There are various initiatives which we have taken, which includes the pre -EMI calling and awareness calling to the customers, which starts three days in advance from the EMI due date to make sure that the customer is aware that EMI is going to hit and he maintains the bank balance in their bank account. So, these are the kind of initiatives which we are taking to ensure the timely collections in the NBF C business.

Mandira: Got it, Sir. How are we different compared to other players?

Ayush Sharma: There are various initiatives where we don't have any physical kind of movement of papers except the original property papers, everything is done through a digital journey which is helping us in keeping our operating costs low compared to other companies at our size, which is something which is different.

Secondly , our customer segment is that where, in truest sense we are doing the financial inclusion where people are having low documented income proofs and low access to the credit. So, that's how we separate ourselves from the other companies in the market.

Mandira: That's very helpful. Thank you.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, Mandira.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Shruti Sharma , an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Shruti Sharma: Thank you for the opportunity. So , I have two questions. What is the vision with respect to demerging the broking entity?

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, Shruti. Currently we don't have any immediate plans to demerge the broking business. It is going to continue as a subsidiary of Choice International in the medium term from here.

Shruti Sharma: Okay. My next question is which locations do we intend to expand in this year like we are looking at more acquisitions?

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Ayush Sharma: Yes. On the expansion phase, we have already discussed that branch expansion is one of the targets and on the acquisition also, we are open to discuss opportunities with various other players in the industry who wants to consolidate with Choice and we are currently right now

also, we are actively in discussion with a couple of such companies.

Shruti Sharma: Okay. Thank you so much, sir. That's all from my side.

Ayush Sharma : Thanks, Shruti.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sanaya Jain , an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Sanaya Jain: I just had like two questions. First, how are you all planning to phase out the passive and active strategy launches in FY27?

Ayush Sharma : I will request Ajay Sir to take over this question.

Ajay Kejriwal: Yes. On the passive strategy, first we are targeting the passive strategies only. So, once we are settled down with passive in the next one year , we will start active also in FY27. The initial phase through we are going with passive only.

Sanaya Jain: Okay. When do you expect the AMC business to break even?

Ajay Kejriwal: We expect not more than three years. In two to three years, we will come on the break even.

Sanaya Jain: Okay. Great sir. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions from the participants, I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for their closing comments.

Arun Poddar: Thank you for joining us today. The first half of FY26 has been steady and we remain focused on sustaining this progress while serving our customer and strengthening our operations. We appreciate your continuing interest in Choice International and look forward to connecting with you again next quarter. Wishing a very good day and a very happy and prosperous Diwali to all of you. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Choice International Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

(This document has been edited for readability purposes.)

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"Choice International Limited (CIL)
Q3 and 9M FY26 Earnings Conference Call "
February 04, 2026

MANAGEMENT : MR. ARUN PODDAR – GROUP CEO - CIL

MR. MANISH JAIN – DEPUTY CEO – CHOICE AMC

MR. ANKIT JAIN – CHIEF PRODUCT & TECHNOLOGY OFFICER - CIL

MR. MANOJ SINGHANIA – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER - CIL

MR. AYUSH SHARMA – HEAD OF INVESTOR RELATIONS - CIL

MODERATOR : MS. VANESSA FERNANDES – ADFACTORS PR INVESTOR RELATIONS

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Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to Q3 and 9M FY26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Choice International Limited. As a reminder, all participants' lines will be in listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone telephone.

I now hand over the conference to Ms. Vanessa Fernandes from Adfactors PR, Investor Relations. Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Vanessa Fernandes : Good evening, everyone. On behalf of Choice International, I welcome you to the earnings conference call for

Quarter 3 and 9M FY26. Joining us today from the management are Mr. Arun Poddar, Group CEO; Mr. Manish Jain, Deputy CEO, Choice AMC; Ankit Jain, CPTO; Mr. Manoj Singhania, CFO; and Ayush Sharma, Head of Investor Relations.

The earnings presentation has been uploaded on the exchanges as well as on the company website. You may refer to it as we walk you through the opening remarks and the discussion during the call.

Before we begin, I would like to remind you that certain statements made during this call may be forward-looking in nature and are subject to risks and uncertainties. These are detailed in the company's annual report and other investor disclosures available on our website. Choice International does not undertake any obligation to publicly update these forward-looking statements.

With that, I will now hand the call over to Mr. Arun Poddar to share his opening remarks. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Arun Poddar: Thank you. Good evening, everyone. It's a pleasure to have you all with us today. As we move through the final stretch of FY26, we are now witnessing a fundamental structural pivot in the Indian economy. Beyond the headline indices, there is a clear equitization of household savings, where capital is steadily migrating from physical assets into financial markets at an unprecedented scale. This shift is not cyclical, it's structural. While cooling inflation and RBI's strategic rate adjustments have eased the cost of capital, the real story for Choice continues to be the resilience of the rural and the semi-urban consumer, who is increasingly aspirational, financially aware, and digitally enabled. This structural shift is further reinforced by the Union Budget '26-'27, which has underscored financial discipline while deepening India's Capital Market ecosystem.

With sustained public capex, MSME formalization, and market-oriented reforms, the policy environment continues to support long-term participation across equities, wealth products, and organized credit areas that are central to our strategy. Our performance this quarter is not just the result of favourable market conditions but also reflects the steady progress we have made in building an integrated financial ecosystem and executing our strategy over the past few years.

We closed 9M FY26 with a revenue of INR 831 crores and a PAT of INR 170 crores. A standout achievement

this quarter was the operational debut of Choice AMC with our first Gold ETF, marking an important milestone in our journey of building a full-stack financial services platform.

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By integrating Ayoleeza Consultant and expanding our wealth platform through the acquisition of wealth distributor businesses of Fintoo and Glory, we are moving from being a service provider to a holistic wealth architect for rural India. With the India Post Payments Bank partnership, we are further strengthening our last-mile reach by enabling digital investment access through one of the country's most extensive distribution networks.

We are no longer just facilitating transactions, we are building

infrastructure for financial independence across

India's under-served and emerging markets, where access, trust, and guidance matter as much as products. Our operational focus remains on depth over breadth, and this philosophy is reflected across each of the business verticals.

In broking and distribution, as the industry adjusts to regulatory changes in the derivative space, our focus on the cash delivery segment has helped maintain our margins and build a more stable long-term investor base. The vertical accounted for 58% of total revenue during the nine-month period, with stock broking client assets reaching INR 60,500 crores in Q3 FY26, registering 22% YoY growth.

Our wealth AUM expanded to INR 4,662 crores up 328% YoY, supported by rising client engagement in delivery-led and long-term investment products. Our 65,000 plus Choice Business Associates continue to be our trust bridge, allowing us to maintain high-touch relationships in a high-tech world. This network has supported the expansion of our Demat base to 12,34,000 accounts, reflecting a 24% YoY increase, driven by seamless capabilities, deeper penetration in tier 2 and tier 3 markets, and a diversified product offering. The insurance vertical delivered consistent growth, aided by the broader partner coverage and the higher adoption of digital journey. Premium collection stood at INR 83 crores in Q3 FY26, marking a 14% YoY growth with more than 50,000 policies sold. This reflects our ability to cross-sell protection products within our ecosystem and deepen wallet share across our client base.

Our NBFC segment continues to strengthen its focus on secured lending. At a time when parts of the unsecured lending markets are under pressure, our focus remains on MSME Micro LAP and the rooftop solar asset. The loan book reaches INR 756 crores as of nine months FY26, with the NBFC business contributing 14% of total revenue. Our in-house collection mechanism remains a key differentiator, utilizing pre-digital alerts and the physical ground team to keep our asset quality strong. NPA remains stable at 2.83% as of December 31, 2025, underscoring the prudence of our underwriting and risk management framework.

Our advisory segment is benefiting from India's massive infrastructure and governance push. With the order book of INR 748 crores, we are deeply embedded in mission projects ranging from digital PACS computerization to World Bank-backed governance initiatives. The advisory business contributed 28% of total revenue, providing revenue visibility for the next 24 to 36 months and adding stability to our earnings profile. Our investment banking business remains execution-led with 15 IPOs completed so far, 37 active mandates, and a tentative fundraising pipeline of INR 9,700 crores, reflecting strong market credibility and deal flow momentum. Together, these pillars underline our view that Choice is well-positioned to participate in India's

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growth by expanding access, building trust, and supporting financial inclusion across a wide section of the country.

I will now hand over to Ayush Sharma, our Head of Investor Relations, who will walk you through the financial performance of the quarter.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, sir. I will now present our financial performance for Q3 and 9M FY26. Choice delivered a consolidated revenue of INR 309 crores in Q3 FY26, reflecting 46% YoY growth. EBITDA stood at INR 117 crores with margin expanding to 37.92%, reflecting our success in decoupling revenue growth from operational expenses. PAT for the quarter was INR 66 crores, delivering a margin of 21.26% and a YoY growth of 114%. For 9M FY26, revenue rose to INR 831 crores, which is up by 25% on a YoY basis. EBITDA reached INR 303 crores with EBITDA margins at 36.45%, while profit after tax stood at INR 170 crore

es with a 56% YoY

growth. These outcomes demonstrate the effectiveness of our execution and the robustness of our operating platform.

Within our business segments, the broking and distribution vertical delivered Q3 revenue of INR 164 crore s

with a PBT of INR 49 crore s. The NBFC segment reported Q3 revenue of INR 40 crore s and PBT of INR 4 crore s. Asset quality in this segment remains stable. We maintained a healthy net interest margin of 12.25%, even as we prioritize high -quality secured portfolios.

The advisory business recorded Q3 revenue of INR 100 crore s with a PBT of INR 38 crore s, driven by high -quality execution and sustained momentum across sectors. A healthy order book and reliable delivery reinforced our role as a trusted advisor across India.

With that, I would now like to open the floor for questions and answers.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question and answer session. The first question is from the line of Samruddhi from DNS Capital. Please go ahead.

Samruddhi: Congratulations on the good set of numbers. My question was regarding a recent project which you have posted on the press release about India Post Payments Bank. So, can you give an update about it, like potential revenue which you are expecting from this and margins, and how many such projects are you looking for?

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, Samruddhi, for the question. See, this project is for integrating our wealth services with India Post Payments Bank's distribution network. Currently, India Post itself has 1.6 lakh post offices, 1.8 lakh postmen who are delivering the servi ces of IPPB as well , which includes savings bank accounts and current accounts of more than 12 crore customers.

Now, this project is to provide wealth management services to these 12 crores existing customers , as well as future customers of IPPB. This opens up a huge distribution channel for our business. So, more than the numbers and margins, it opens up an avenue for onboarding more and more customers, and this is technically the lar gest distribution system across India. So, we will utilize this partnership and grow more in semi -urban and rural geographies, which will expand our reach to the end users. So, that's the outcome of this particular project which we foresee.

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Samruddhi: Okay, understood. And secondly, I had a doubt about Gold ETF, do you have any plans in that segment, any timelines for active strategies?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. I will request the Deputy CEO of AMC, Mr. Manish Jain to take up this question.

Manish Jain: Thank you. In terms of product portfolio, currently we have Gold ETF and next we would be going ahead with the index funds. And to supplement the flow in the index fund, we would be launching the overnight fund.

That's the plan for this fiscal year. In the next fiscal year, we will complement our basket with commodit ies.

So, that's where you will see that a couple of commodity ETFs, which are missing in the stock , that will get added up.

Once these two stacks are completed, we will get into the active stra tegy. So, as an AMC, we want to give a choice to our investors both on the passive side as well as on the active side. And on the passive side, we want to cover equities as well as the commodities.

Samruddhi: Okay, understood. Thank you. Thank you for taki ng my question.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nikita Mehta, an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Nikita Mehta: Hi sir, thank you for the opportunity. I have a few questions. Sir, first is what are the key drivers behind the 45% YoY revenue growth in this quarter, particularly the contribution from Broking vs the NBFC and advisory segments?

Ayush Sharma: So, thank you Nikita. The largest drivers are the increased trading activities from the retail investors which we have seen during

the quarter. As our fixed costs are stable and operating costs are not directly increasing with the increase in the revenues, we are able to expand on the margins as well during this quarter across the broking business.

Similar expansion in th e margins we have seen in the advisory business also, which is largely driven by the same team executing multiple projects , which is resulting in a higher revenue being generated for the P&L. So, both these businesses have grown very well during this quart er as compared to the Q3 FY25, and this has led to a larger growth in the revenues as well as an expansion in margins.

Moreover, Choice Broking has been one of the top five brokers which has seen a net client addition as per the NSE's active UCC list over the last couple of quarters. So, that has also contributed largely to our growth in the revenue as well as growth in the active clients.

Nikita Mehta: Okay, sir, that answers my question. And sir, I have one more question. EBITDA margins expanded to 37.9% in Q3 FY26 from 29.2% YoY . Can you just elaborate on the sustainability of this expansion due to the rising employee costs?

Ayush Sharma: So, on the E BITDA margin, what we foresee that as we grow the top line, the EBITDA margins are going to be sustained and even expand further. So, we don't foresee any major constraint on sustaining this EBITDA margin per se. This is largely in sync with the growth of the overall revenue as the fixed cost and the operational costs are not increasing at the rate at which the revenue is growing. So, we foresee EBITDA margins to continue above the current levels.

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Nikita Mehta: Okay, sir. That was really helpful. And all the best for the future.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Neil John from B&K Securities. Please go ahead.

Neil John: Hello, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. There's a couple of questions that I have. So, one is on the active clients front. As you said, we have seen a growth in active clients and even our market share has increased on a YoY basis if you look at December's numbers. It's a marginal increase, so I want to know what your perspective is on the future, how do we look to expand this market share?

Secondly, also on the cost of acquisition of customers, how has that moved on a YoY basis? Are you finding it more difficult now with the markets kind of being more volatile? How's that trend playing out?

And my second question is on the MTF book side. I think I missed the performance for this quarter. How is the book scaling, sir, and there have been some industry commentary around the risk on the MTF front? So, if you have some commentary on that also.

Ayush Sharma: Thanks, John, for taking out time to join this call. Firstly, on your question on the active clients and market share, see, we are in a phygital business model where we have physical presence on the ground and the whole execution is done using the technology. So, our sourcing mechanism remains the physical channels which includes our branches as well as the AP network and our CBAs which we have.

So that setup is already there in place. And with this setup, we believe that even today in the semi-urban geographies or even Tier 3 and below geographies, people require a physical presence of the platform providers through whom the people are investing their hard-earned money. So, that is the larger philosophy behind having this particular business model.

This model is the largest reason for having the net addition in the active clients over the last couple of quarters where the overall industry has seen a decline or the larger players have seen a decline in the active clients. So, that's going to remain intact and which is also helping us to keep the client acquisition cost stable. We don't see a major rise in the client acquisition cost because

of the fixed cost we are already anyway incurring, and the more and more clients which we onboard, our client acquisition cost remains stable.

On your question of the MTF, currently we are maintaining an average book of roughly around between INR 370 to INR 400 crores. On the risk part, we as Choice Broking, we have placed robust internal risk management systems. We have not seen any sort of risk arising from our customer base and on our platform. Our target is to grow the MTF book very aggressively over the next one financial year.

So, that's the target which we are taking on the MTF book and from the risk perspective, our systems are very robust and we don't foresee any major challenge on the risk management side within Choice.

Neil John: Thank you, sir. Just one follow-up. Would you be able to quantify, like, what is the average exposure for your clients on the MTF front?

Ayush Sharma: Neil, unfortunately, I don't have that number readily available with me, but we will try to include that number in our earnings presentation next time if feasible.

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Neil John: Sure, sir. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rohan Shah, an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Rohan Shah: Hello. Hi, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. I had two questions. One is with regards to the CAGR, which stands at 50.53% with collections efficiency of 90%. How will the management manage funding costs and liability mix to support 20% to 30% AUM growth?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. So, the CAGR which you are talking is on the overall consolidated revenue, I think. And that revenue is including the broking, advisory, and NBFC businesses. So, we have been delivering this growth rate over the last five years, and we are very much confident about maintaining a similar range over the next couple of years as well. With our current business plans, we are very well positioned to achieve the same numbers. Specifically on the NBFC side, our AUM is largely contributed by the retail loans where we have the physical presence on the ground and do the physical credit underwriting using the most advanced technology tools available as well. So, that will help us maintain our high collection efficiency and lower credit cost. With the help of our existing physical presence itself, we are very sure that we will be able to achieve an AUM growth of 20% to 30% over the next couple of years.

Rohan Shah: Great, great. And on the recent acquisition, how will it contribute to FY26 execution in infra consulting?

Ayush Sharma: Yes. So, on the recent acquisition of Ayoleeza Consultants, they have very good credentials of working with various governments. The larger reason was that there were certain geographies where we were not having certain credentials, which Ayoleeza has, and with the help of new credentials coming in, we will be able to expand on to the geographies where we get more contracts from more states, which will be adding up on our order book and therefore increasing our overall revenue. So, that's the largest advantage which we foresee from the acquisition of Ayoleeza Consultants.

Rohan Shah: Okay. Thank you. Thank you for that. All the best, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shruti Sharma from Family Office. Please go ahead.

Shruti Sharma: Yes. Hi, good evening, sir. Just a couple of questions from my side. First, could you share your plans around Capex for FY26, like particularly on technology investments or branch expansion?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. So, on the tech side, no thing major on the capex; however, opex is the only thing which we have largely

on the tech side. And branch expansion is also not very significant since our average cost of each new branch is not very significant. It ranges somewhere between INR 3,00,000 to INR 5,00,000. So, tha

t's not very

significant in terms of capex. However, on the IT capex and opex, I would request our CFO, Mr. Manoj Singhanian, to throw some light on the numbers during this particular quarter.

Manoj Singhanian: Hi. During the quarter, total expenses along with capex was around INR 10 crores for broking business.

Ayush Sharma: Okay, okay. So, I hope that helps your question, Shruti.

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Shruti Sharma: Yes, yes. Yes, sir. And secondly, could you help us with any broad full-year guidance on revenue growth and PAT growth that management is currently targeting?

Ayush Sharma: So, we have been delivering double-digit growth which has been upwards of 20 %-25%. We expect to maintain

similar growth rates over the next couple of years as well.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mandira, an individual investor. Please go ahead.

Mandira: Hello. Thanks for the opportunity. So, I have a couple of questions. With Demat account at 1.23 million and ADTO market share steady at 1.2%, what strategies are in place to accelerate the client acquisition in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities?

Ayush Sharma: So, Mandira, as I mentioned, largely the physical expansion of our branches and our CBA network is going to contribute more towards the customer acquisition. However, off-late, we have started building a digital client acquisition team as well. I would request Mr. Ankit Jain to throw some light on the digital client acquisition mechanism which we have in place. We have Mr. Ankit Jain, CPTO, who will throw some light on this acquisition model.

Ankit Jain: Hello everyone. Regarding the acquisition model, from last one or two years, we have been building the entire infrastructure which is helping us to get the user in a lower CAC. Because in the world of digital, the bigger pain is the CAC which needs to be sustainable for the business. So, from last two years we are working on that and right now we are seeing a good growth in that aspect. So, basis that, we are planning a major growth in the digital world.

Also, we are building the complete financial ecosystem for the end user where our entire theory and the thought process is to whoever client we are acquiring, we should have an ecosystem where we can create a higher LTV using multiple products. We don't want it to be like a simple stockbroking application, we want it to be a complete financial hub for the end user, where the recent product additions such as credit as well as the dedicated F&O section for the user are some which are in pipeline or something which we have delivered in this quarter, where the thought is how we can get more LTV of the user.

Ayush Sharma: Yes. Okay. Thank you, Ankit. Mandira, I hope that answers your question.

Mandira: Secondly, insurance premium hit ₹835 Mn with 50.6K policies; what is the plan to sustain 58% revenue growth amid POSP expansion?

Ayush Sharma: So, again, Mandira, as I mentioned, something sort of 25% growth rate is something which we are targeting in the insurance distribution business as well. You would see in our earnings presentation that we are catering to both corporate as well as retail customers in the insurance distribution business, which is going to continue expanding in both the segments, and that will contribute to the growth rate upwards of 25%.

Mandira: Got it, sir. Thank you. That was really helpful. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Urmish Shah from Moneywisers. Please go ahead.

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Urmish Shah: Yes. I had just one question. If I see your presentation on the slide of Choice Connect, I see the credit card issue has gone down by 6%, and also the clients onboarded in this quarter have declined. So, any reason could you give?

Ayush Sharma: Yes. On the

credit cards front, we had certain technological glitch with the integration with one of the banks for which we have been working. That was for a brief period of around 40-45 days which has led to the

reduction in the number. That glitch has been resolved now, and we have seen an uptick in the month of January. So, we fore see that this number is going to remain stable in Q4. So, we don't foresee a major impact there. S o we expect this to be a temporary impact and not a sustained impact.

Urmish Shah : Okay. A nd on the onboarding of clients of equity?

Ayush Sharma: Yes. So, onboarding of clients of Choice Equity, since we were gearing up for the contes t of JFM period, the existing contests were withdrawn, which has led to a slight degrowth in the client onboarding. As we have launched the JFM contests for the CBAs as well, th is will also normalize during the Q4 FY26 .

Urmish Shah : Okay. Okay. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions from participants, I now hand over the conference to management for closing comments. Over to you, sir.

Arun Podd ar: Thank you for insightful questions. Our journey in FY26 has been about scaling with discipline. Our focus remains on technological innovation and deepening our presence in India's un derserved market s. On behalf of the entire Choice team, I wish you all a prosperous new year ahead. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Choice International Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

(This document has been edited for readability purposes.)

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"Choice International Limited
Q4 & FY26 Earnings Conference Call "
April 24, 2026

MANAGEMENT : MR. ARUN PODDAR – GROUP CHIEF EXECUTIVE
OFFICER – CIL
MR. AJAY KEJRIWAL – EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR – CIL
MR. AYUSH SHARMA – HEAD OF INVESTOR
RELATIONS – CIL

MODERATOR : MS. FORUM GOSHER – ADFACTORS PR INVESTOR
RELATIONS

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Mod erator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Q4 & FY26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Choice International Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen - only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance dur ing this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand over the conference to Ms . Forum Gosher from Adfactors PR, Investor Relations. Thank you and over to you, M s. Forum.

Forum Gosher: Good evening, everyone. On behalf of Choice International Limited, I welcome you all to the earnings conference call for Q4 & FY26. Joining us today from the management team are Mr. Arun Poddar, Group CEO; Mr. Aja y Kejriwal, Executive Director; and Mr. Ayush Sharma, Head of Investor Relations.

The earnings presentation has been uploaded on the exchanges as well as on the company website. You may refer to it as we walk you through the opening remarks and the discus sions during the call.

Before we begin, I would like to remind you that certain statements made during this call may be forward -looking in nature and are subject to risks and uncertainties. These are detailed in the company's Annual Report and other Investor disclosures available on the website. Choice International Limited does not undertake any obligation to publicly update these forward - looking statements.

With that, I will now hand over the call to Mr. Arun Poddar to share his opening remarks. Th ank you and over to you, sir.

Arun Poddar: Good evening, everyone and thank you for joining us today. In FY26, India maintained steady progress backed by a stable policy environment and consistent execution. There is a growing confidence across sectors dri ven not just by expectation but by the change already visible on the ground. Continued investment by global players across industries such as technology, manufacturing, service, energy, and logistics reflect that long -term commitment to India's growth stor y.

In this context, our performance in Q4 FY26 reflects stable progress for Choice with continued momentum across our institutional, distribution, and product -led business. Our focus during the quarter remai ned on strengthening our platform, expanding our reach, and building partnerships while also growing our presence in areas such as public sector advisory.

During the quarter, our consulting subsidiary secured government mandates aggregating approximately Rs. 55 Cr. These mandates span program management, governance reform, and digital transformation indicating our growing presence in public sector advisory space.

In wealth management, we secured a digital investment platform mandate from India Post Payments Bank. This provides access to a large distribution network and support our effort to scale this business. In asset management, we expanded our offering with the launch of the Choice Nifty 50 Index Fund and Choice Nifty Next 50 Index Fund in line with our focus on long-term investing solutions.

Our business performance this quarter reflected a deliberate emphasis on building strength within each vertical rather than pushing broad-based expansion. In broking and distribution, our focus continued to be on the cash delivery segment. This has helped maintain margins and build a more stable clientele base. The segment contributed 59% to total revenue with stock broking AUM at R s. 52,482 Cr in Q4 FY26, growing 28% YoY. Wealth AUM stood at R s. 4,268 Cr supported by steady client participation in delivery-led products.

Our netw

ork with 67,000 Choice Business Associates remains an important part of our distribution strategy. This model allows us to combine digital capabilities with on-ground presence, helping us expand our reach while maintaining client engagement.

During the quarter, our Demat account base grew to 13 lakhs, up 16% YoY, supported by improved onboarding and a wider product offering. In the insurance business, we saw consistent growth driven by a broader partner network and increased use of digital platforms. Premium collection stood at R s. 84 Cr in Q4 FY26, reflecting 14% YoY growth, while policy volumes stood at 50,887 number of policies.

In our NBFC segment, we continue to focus on secured lending given the current environment in unsecured lending. Our emphasis on MSME, micro-LAP, rooftop solar financing support more stable growth. The loan book stood at R s. 800 Cr as of FY26 with the segment contributing 13% to total revenue. Our in-house collection process continues to support asset quality with NNPA remaining stable at 1.86% as of March 31, 2026.

The advisory business continues to benefit our ongoing infrastructure and governance-related projects with an order book of R s. 698 Cr. We are working on projects such as digital PACS, and multilateral support initiatives. This segment contributed 28% to total revenue and provides visibility over the next two to three years.

Let me pass it on to Ayush Sharma, our Head of Investor Relations, who will present the quarter's financial performance. Thank you.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, sir. I will now walk you through our financial performance for Q4 & FY26. During the quarter, Choice reported consolidated revenue of R s. 314 Cr, representing a growth of 23% on a YoY basis. EBITDA for the quarter stood at R s. 123 Cr with margins at 39.08% reflecting improved operating efficiency. Profit after tax came in at R s. 68 Cr translating into a margin of 21.62% and a YoY growth of 27%.

For the full year FY26, consolidated revenue was at R s. 1,145 Cr, up 24% compared to last year. EBITDA stood at R s. 425 Cr with margins at 37%, while PAT was R s. 238 Cr reflecting a

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growth of 46% on a year-on-year basis. Overall, the performance reflects steady execution across businesses and continued strength in our operating model.

Looking at segment performance, the broking and distribution business reported revenue of R s. 179 Cr in Q4 FY26 with a PBT of R s. 55 Cr. Our Demat account base has grown to 12.63 lakhs, while we are seeing increased engagement per client supported by cross-selling of insurance and wealth products through the FinX platform.

The NBFC segment recorded revenue of R s. 43 Cr and PBT of R s. 2 Cr during the quarter. Asset quality remains stable with GNPA at 2.74% and NNPA at 1.86%. This has been supported by disciplined underwriting, improved collections, and a diversified loan book. Net interest margins remained healthy at 11.22% in line with our focus on secured lending.

In the advisory segment, Q4 FY26 revenue stood at R s. 91 crore with a PBT of R s. 31 Cr. For FY26, the segment reported revenue of R s. 330 Cr and a PBT of R s. 120 Cr. Performance during the period was supported by steady execution and continued inflow of mandates including repeat engagements.

With this, I would now like to open the floor for any questions.

Moderator: Thank you. We will now begin the Q&A session. The first question is from the line of Urmish

Shah from Money wisers . Thank you and over to you.

Urmish Shah: Thank you for the opportunity. My first question is on the wealth product AUM ; we witnessed a 23% decline. Could you give some color on that?

Ayush Sharma: Sure. If you see, there is a decline in overall AUM, however, there is a growth of 35% in the equity MF AUM. The decline is largely driven by redemptions in the debt mutual f

unds, which

is natural because of the market sentiment where in people withdraw their excess capital deployed in debt and tend to invest in equities at a better price. So, that's the larger reason which is driving the reduction in the debt AUM. The margins in equity is higher for the company compared to debt mutual funds, therefore there is no larger impact on the overall revenue of the company.

Urmish Shah: As you were saying the reason, is this what we'll witness if the market conditions are not stabilized going further? Do you see that in the future?

Ayush Sharma: No, our focus product is also equity AUM. We will see a consistent growth in the equity mutual funds. So, that's largely a treasury product, that will not be our core focus product. Our core focus will be equity MF only.

Urmish Shah: On the NBFC, are we comfortable with our provision coverage ratio? In your opening comments, you did mention that NPAs are stable that way, but still, we see a 1 or 3 bps increase in the NPA. Could that be somewhat streamlined?

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Ayush Sharma: On the provision coverage ratio, it is driven by an established market practice of ECL, expected credit loss as per the accounting standards. We have adopted the accounting policy defined by the accounting standards and whatever is calculated by the policy of accounting standards, we are preparing the provisions.

On the asset quality side, you can see a growth in the overall YoY numbers . However, during the year there has been certain rise in the NPA numbers , which has come down in Q4 FY26.

This rise was largely driven by the overall economic impacts which we had seen in the microfinance segment, but now things seem to be normalizing starting this quarter.

Urmish Shah: My next question is on the insurance side. We see a decline in the corporate side of the business, in which we had seen previously as well. So, is that segment in a bit of a doldrum ?

Ayush Sharma: Overall, there has been a growth in the insurance premium and larger contribution has come from retail insurances rather than the corporate insurances. There has not been major impact on the revenues. However, there we had seen for last two quarters slight reduction in the corporate insurance premium.

During the last year, we had got insurance premium from certain government contracts. That was the larger reason why there was higher insurance premium in the previous financial year ; when we compare that number to this year's number; you see a decline. However, the corporate insurance premium is for the corporates, it is as per our expected range only.

Urmish Shah: Lastly, on the mandate with Assam Industrial Green Growth Fund ; as I see on your Slide 39, could you give some color on how will be the structure and how the things will proceed and whether FY27 is the year that we are looking forward to go up about it?

Ayush Sharma: The Government of Assam has mandated Choice Capital Advisors Private Limited to assist them in setting up the AIF and then doing the roadshows for the fundraising for the AIF as well. Our role is to assist the government, although the fund management etc etc will be done by the government themselves.

Urmish Shah: Okay. Thank you, sir. I'll join back.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shweta Sharma from Arihant Capital. Thank you and go ahead.

Shweta Sharma: Thank you so much . The revenue grew in FY26 , but PAT margin remains probably stable. What are the key levers you are targeting to expand net margin over the next 2-3 years?

Ayush Sharma: We have expansion in the net margins as well during this particular financial year. However, to expand the margins further, the larger use of tech is going to play a role as we achieve the higher scales. Our fixed costs are not going to increase. As seen in the Q4 performance , the

revenues

have grown by 23% , but the profit has grown by 46% for FY26. So, that higher growth than the

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revenue in profit after tax shows the higher expansion in the margins. That will continue to expand as we leverage on the technology, and the fixed cost remains stable.

Shweta Sharma: Okay. Your acquisition of Optimo Investment Adviser and the IPPB partnership seems like a push into deeper Tier -2 and Tier -3 markets. What is the projected customer acquisition cost for these channels compared to your traditional digital channels?

Ayush Sharma: Traditionally we are largely focused on semi-urban geographies, Tier -2, Tier -3, Tier -4 geographies where we acquire customers. However, at the same time, the execution is completely digital and tech-driven, which is through our mobile app or through our web trading platform etc. But the acquisition is still physical, which is driven by branches, CBAs. Coming to your question on the acquisition partnership with the IPPB, their existing customer base, we will be providing the services to their existing customer base; thereby making our customer acquisition negligible or at a very low level because we will be earning revenues from the cross-sell which we do to their existing customer base. So, we don't see much of the customer acquisition cost increase while having a partnership with IPPB.

Shweta Sharma: Okay. As you scale the book, are you seeing any compression in yields specifically? What is the current GNPA and NNPA trend in newly acquired Paisabuddy retail lending portfolio?

Ayush Sharma: The acquired portfolio is also behaving in line with our portfolio. When we had acquired, we had done a comparative study and the study stated that both the portfolios of Choice and Paisabuddy are similar in nature in terms of customer segment and geographies. Therefore, the performance is also similar. We don't see a differentiated performance in the portfolio acquired from Paisabuddy.

Shweta Sharma: Okay. Are you seeing any compression in yields?

Ayush Sharma: Definitely, as we grow further and as we originate better credits, there is going to be a rate reduction. However, that will be a marginal, not a very significant impact in the compression of the NIM. But, at the same time, the impact will be seen in the asset quality also, thereby increasing our ROE only and not having any negative impact on the ROE.

Shweta Sharma: Okay. Lastly, which segments will be the primary growth engines going forward?

Ayush Sharma: All four segments are focused segments for us. There is nothing primary or nothing secondary. There is no segment which is of non-core focus. All these are growing and all these will continue to grow in future as well. We have dedicated CEOs for all the segments and all business verticals. The day-to-day execution and business decisions are taken care of by all of them. So, all of them will continue to grow and eventually, become a larger organization.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Suraj Shinde from Yes Securities. Thank you and go ahead.

Suraj Shinde: Thank you for the opportunity. I have few questions. Firstly, as the base grows larger, what is your realistic medium-term growth guidance across revenue and profitability?

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Ayush Sharma: We have been constantly communicating as well as projecting internally to maintain a growth rate of around 30 % on YoY basis across revenues and profitability.

Suraj Shinde: Okay. What are we doing to convert dormant demat holders into active traders and what is the target activation ratio over the next 12 months?

Ayush Sharma: When we talk about the dormant demat holders, there are different types of customers which we segregate internally. These are classified into investors, tra

ders and somewhat followers. So,

these are the three categories which we classify in and accordingly for each category a different set of actions are taken to activate the dormant demat holders.

The larger push for activation is through our digital channels by understanding their other investments, by understanding their kind of investment philosophy and then sending the nudges and sending the attractive opportunities to invest in the market. So, these are the steps which we take depending on the customer investment philosophy and customer behavior.

Suraj Shinde: Okay. My last question is that digital adoption is something that is rising right now. What percent of revenue is now coming from digital channels and how do we see this evolving?

Ayush Sharma: Around 70 % is coming from digital channels. When I say digital channels, these are trades executed on the platform. It can be our mobile app, it can be web trading platform. The offline channels include the call & trade facility and dealer terminals. So, you can see 70% of the revenue is generated through trades placed on the online modes.

Suraj Shinde: Okay, sir. That helps. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shruti Sharma from Family Office. Thank you and over to you.

Shruti Sharma: My first question is could you share your near-term AUM target for the AMC segment for FY 27 and also provide some colour on the cost structure for running the AMC business?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. Our one-year target in the AM C business, is to reach at Rs. 1,000 Cr of AUM at the close of FY 27.

Shruti Sharma: Okay. In the insurance distribution segment, how is the corporate versus retail mix expected to evolve going forward? What is the target mix management is working on much ?

Ayush Sharma: Okay. On the insurance side, we plan to keep 50 -50 mix between corporate and retail in future as well.

Shruti Sharma: Okay. That answers my questions. Thank you so much and all the best for next quarter.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you.

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Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nikita Mehta, an Investor. Thank you and go ahead.

Nikita Mehta: Thank you for the opportunity . I have a couple of questions. Q4 growth looks strong. Did you see any slowdown in March and April due to market volatility or has the momentum continued in FY 27?

Ayush Sharma: Thank you, Nikita, for this question. Of course, there has been the volatility in the market. However, since our business is largely driven by the volumes, even in the volatile market, the volume has remained on an upward trajectory and therefore our revenues have grown and in line with the growth in the overall volumes. So , we didn't face any much of the impact because of the market volatility and same we are expecting for FY 27 until and unless a larger geopolitical issue comes up, we don't foresee a major impact on the overall revenues.

Nikita Mehta: Okay. What kind of ROCE and ROE thresholds do you target for the new investments?

Ayush Sharma: There are no new investments we are making and there are no new segments in which we are expanding as of now. So , it's the existing businesses which we will continue to grow.

Nikita Mehta: I think it answers my question, sir. All the best for the future.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Rohan Mehta, an individual investor. Thank you and go ahead.

Rohan Mehta: Thank you for this opportunity. Sir, if you could touch upon the India Post Payments Bank partnership for us, it is quite compelling with over 1,50,000 post offices and 12 Cr odd customers. But it would be safe to assume that most of these would be relatively low income or financially underserved customers who might have a limited capacity into SIPs. Could you shed some light on what your a

verage SIP ticket size you would expect for this segment and how the unit economics would pan out for us, compared to our existing wealth client base ?

Ayush Sharma: Thanks Rohan, for this question. Our arrangement with India Post Payments Bank is to provide a platform to the existing customers to invest in the mutual funds. That's the core role. There will be multiple activities which we will be doing while ensuring the goals of this partnership . The largest would be providing a digital platform, integrating our platform with the India Post Payments Bank's platform. Number two , will be to conduct an extensive training for the front office team of the India Post Payments Bank. Then number three is the providing the services to the customers.

Now in this case, as your question is on the size of the SIP and assumptions on the low income category , I would like to clarify here that the partnership is with India Post Payments Bank and not the post office. So , although Post Payments Bank leverage the distribution platform distribution channels which is created by the post office, but the customers which are there on

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the India Post Payments Bank have are not the same customers as of the post office . They have a higher investment capability because normally people tend to invest in the post offices in terms of recurring deposits model.

Coming to the size, it will be lower as compared to the metro customer , but not as low as a post office customer as well. It will be lying somewhere in between. On a realistic target, we are expecting it will remain somewhere between Rs. 2,000 to Rs. 2,500 per customer per month.

Rohan Mehta: Okay. Got it, sir. Would you be looking at a sort of a break -even period by when the investment in this partnership will start contributing to our bottom line?

Ayush Sharma: Currently the tech integration is going on and we'll go live in this quarter. We expect that from 1st of July, we will start having revenues in our balance sheet and the profitability will start

coming in.

Rohan Mehta: Got it. That is helpful. If I could ask touch upon the advisory segment also ; our order book on that front seems to have declined QoQ , which is a first in many of the historical quarters. So , this order execution running ahead of fresh order wins, is that the case or are we seeing any slowdown in government project tendering which might run into the next financial year's advisory revenues?

Ayush Sharma: There isn't any slowdown in the business per se. Being Q4, the larger target was on executing the projects and completing this , within this the previous financial year itself and that is why you see a decline in this quarter for the first time. Until now, you must have seen the growth in the overall order book only. As the orders are executed, you could see a decline, but in this quarter, we are very confident and the pipeline looks very strong and we will get more contracts which will enable us to grow the order book, compared to the previous quarter as well.

Rohan Mehta: Got it. Within this segment itself, would you be concerned about the concentration of orders that we have, particularly from the infrastructure consulting part or within Maharashtra as a state, accounting for a fair share of our exposure? Is concentration a risk and would we be looking to diversify and reduce these percentages?

Ayush Sharma: Of course the contribution of these states and sectors are high, but we don't see a major risk immediate risk of this concentration. However, the focus of the management is definitely to expand to other states as well. The others which you see in the earnings presentation includes 22 other states where we have the current orders live and where we are expanding our businesses as well. So , as the other states grow, this contribution will come down.

Rohan Mehta: O

kay. Got it. Within the next financial year ?

Ayush Sharma: Yes

Rohan Mehta: Lastly, on the AMC business ; if we are going to be moving from passive to active strategy in the next fiscal year in terms of active fund management and the sort of talent profile that might

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be required, are we looking at some new hiring in terms of fund managers and if you have any threshold in terms of what kind of AUMs we should be dealing in in the AMC business?

Ayush Sharma: On the team side, we are in talks with the industry experts and we are on -boarding new people to expand the team. That is the first activity which we are we have been doing for some time now to build the base for the active strategies. This financial year we will come up with the active schemes as well.

Rohan Mehta: In terms of the AUM threshold , do we have any or are we going to have any minimum AUM that would contribute positively to our overall consolidated ROEs?

Ayush Sharma: For the AMC business, we are targeting an AUM of Rs. 1000 Cr for FY27.

Rohan Mehta: That's very helpful. Thank you for taking my questions and all the best, sir.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nishita from Crown Capital. Thank you and please go ahead.

Nishita: I just had a follow-up on the previous participant's question. You mentioned that the order pipeline is quite strong and we see good orders coming in Q1. So, if you can quantify what is our current order book and how does the pipeline look like?

Ayush Sharma: The current order book is Rs. 698 Cr and the current projects that we have submitted our bids as these orders are awarded by way of tendering and are more than Rs. 400 Cr.

Nishita: Okay. What is generally our like winning ratio?

Ayush Sharma: It depends on location to location and there cannot be a generalized winning ratio, but it all depends on various factors. So, that is not a relevant kind of metric .

Nishita: Okay. Got it. Thank you so much.

Ayush Sharma: Thanks.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Rutvi Gandhi, an investor. Thank you and go ahead.

Rutvi Gandhi: My first question is that how does the management expect the revenue mix to evolve over the next three years as the AMC, NBFC, and IB business scale?

Ayush Sharma: All these businesses are classified into three segments: broking and distribution, advisory, and NBFC. We expect all of them to grow at a faster pace and the mix will remain somewhere between, 50-40-10 kind of ratios . 50% for broking and distribution, 40% for advisory, and 10% for the NBFC.

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Rutvi Gandhi: Understood. Do we have any plans to monetize our advisory capabilities separately?

Ayush Sharma: What do you mean by monetizing the capability separately?

Rutvi Gandhi: As you said earlier that we do not have any preferences as in our primary and secondary categories business-wise, but other than that, do we have any plans to go aggressively on the advisory wing?

Ayush Sharma: Advisory is a core function of the company and there is a dedicated team of roughly around 2,000 people in the government advisory business. There is a team of more than 150 employees in the investment banking team. We have dedicated teams, dedicated leadership, dedicated, business and execution heads. All of them are taking care of the businesses very well and these are going to grow at a higher pace. So, there is no specific preference per se to give primary focus to any business from the hold-co management side.

Rutvi Gandhi: Understood. Thank you so much.

Ayush Sharma: Thanks.

Moderator: The next question is from Ramesh Thorani from Mehta Brothers. Thank you and please go ahead.

Ramesh Thorani: Good evening, sir, and thank you for the opportunity

. Just wanted to understand, what steps are

we taking or what initiatives we are undertaking on the AI part of the business? How do we plan to implement AI in generating additional revenues and generating additional benefit to our customers?

Ayush Sharma: We have separate established and dedicated team to implement AI across all business verticals. There have been specific sections where we have automated with the use of AI across all businesses already. Largely the AI's use is on the data analytics and preparing the summarized outcome or the actionable for a particular activity. We have established that currently for the back office and data analytics kind of functions. So, that is there in place. As we develop new models on the AI, we will keep implementing on the front-end customer-facing activities as well subject to regulatory compliance.

Ramesh Thorani: From what we understand from few of the competitors on the broking side, they have been building some AI layers and some capabilities in terms of their strategies as well. How are we planning to give something different to our customers? Just wanted to understand your thoughts around that as well.

Ayush Sharma: In our case, as I mentioned that analytics is the larger part which we are doing for the broking business also. Take an example; that now AI decides that which customer should get which notification at what time; so that he gets the right information at the right time. So, these are the kind of activities which we have piloted with the use of AI and will be implementing in the due course as the models mature.

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Ramesh Thorani: Got it. Just wanted to understand, on the capital allocation side, since we have multiple businesses and we have an AMC, we have a broking business, we have NBFC, and we have an advisory business. So, how do you plan to allocate the capital requirements? On the bandwidth of the management; are there separate heads and how the structure works if you can just elaborate on that?

Ayush Sharma: On the bandwidth of management side, we have dedicated CEOs for each of the businesses who takes care of the day-to-day business operations and the growth strategies. At the hold-co level, we decide an AOP i.e. annual operating plan, at the beginning of the year and then we do a tracking on a regular month-on-month basis. So, there is no challenge in the from the management bandwidth or management availability side. That's on the manpower aspect.

On the capital aspect, we have the enough internal accruals as well to support all businesses.

Although all of our businesses are self-sufficient now, they don't need much of the capital.

However, as far as the growth capital is required, the hold-co is sufficiently capable to support any of the business required. There is no preference there as well and as and when required, any business needs growth capital, we are capable to support the business in terms of capital aspect.

Ramesh Thorani: Good to understand that part. Any thoughts around demerging these businesses and listing them separately in the near term?

Ayush Sharma: Not immediately. Of course, the value unlock will be one of the target, but there are no immediate plans to do so.

Ramesh Thorani: Okay. Thank you for the opportunity and all the best and looking forward to interacting with you next quarter.

Ayush Sharma: Thank you very much.

Moderator: As there are no further questions from the participants, I now hand the conference over to Mr. Arun Poddar for closing comments.

Arun Poddar: Thank you. all the participants. Thank you for your questions and continued engagement. In FY26, our effort have been centered on growing the business in a balanced and disciplined way. As we move forward, our priorities will be to strengthen our technology capabilities and further

expand our presence. Thank you everyone.

Moderator: On behalf of Choice International Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

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